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– DEMOCRACY AND EVERYDAY LIFE IN DENMARK



COLOPHON

Learning material for the citizenship test – democracy
and everyday life in Denmark

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Introduction

Learning material for the Citizenship Test – democracy and everyday life in Denmark

Study material for the Citizenship Test is a study material that participants in the Citizenship Test must use in their preparation for the test. The study material covers the topics that you may be asked questions about in the Citizenship Test. The study material provides answers to the questions that you may be asked in the Citizenship Test.

The learning material has been prepared by the Danish Agency for International Recruitment and Integration. It is important to note that the Learning Material for the Citizenship Test is the only official material that prepares for the Citizenship Test. If, for example, other preparation materials for the Citizenship Test are offered on the Internet, these are materials that have not been approved by the Ministry. These materials cannot therefore be used as an alternative to the Learning Materials for the Citizenship Test.

Learning material for the Citizenship Test is only published on the website danskogproever.dk and is not available in a printed version.

Learning material for the Citizenship Test consists of 26 fact sheets about Denmark, each dealing with one specific topic.

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The fact sheets can be read independently of each other, and you can therefore read them in the order you want. Some words in the fact sheets are marked with the symbol *. This means that the word is explained in more detail in a glossary, which can be found at the back of the learning material. If there are other words that you have difficulty understanding in the fact sheets, it is important to research what the word means – for example by looking it up in a dictionary.

Fact sheet 1:

School

Education is compulsory in Denmark. All children must have at least ten years of education. Most parents choose to send their children to primary school.

However, parents can also choose for their child to receive education elsewhere than in primary school. For example, they can choose to send their child to a private school or independent school. Here, the parents must pay directly to the school for the child's education.

They do not have to if the child is in primary school. It is a requirement* that children in independent and private schools must learn the same as children in primary school.

This fact sheet is about:

- Elementary school
- Parental cooperation
- Free primary schools

ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

Most children in Denmark begin their education in primary school. Primary school is free for all children and lasts 10 years. Children start in kindergarten when they are around six years old. Here the children begin to learn letters and numbers.

After kindergarten, there are grades 1 to 9. The education in elementary school must ensure that the children learn enough to be able to continue on to upper secondary education.

The subjects taught include Danish, English, German, mathematics, physics, chemistry, history, social studies, Christian studies, music, physical education (sports) and culinary arts (cooking).

Another important purpose of education in primary school is to ensure that children learn to think critically and independently, thereby preparing them to be citizens in a democratic society. Children therefore learn to express their opinions.

Children can also form student councils and thus have influence* when decisions need to be made. decisions are made at school.



Finally, the social element plays an important role in primary school. Children learn to work together in groups and to solve problems through cooperation. It is also often part of the school curriculum that students, together with their teachers, participate in joint excursions and camp schools.

A primary school usually has three stages: Primary school, which runs from kindergarten to 3rd grade. Middle school, which runs from 4th to 6th grade. Secondary school, which runs from 7th to 9th grade. After 9th grade, you can choose to continue in 10th grade before moving on in the education system, or directly into the labor market.

10th grade is voluntary, but approximately half of all students enroll in 10th grade. Some students take 10th grade at their own school, if it has a 10th grade. Others choose to take the 10th grade at a further education or independent vocational school, where they live and go to school with other young people. The framework* for primary school is laid down in the Primary School Act. It states, among other things, what the purpose of primary school is, what should be taught, and how many hours the students should have.

The purpose of primary school is to provide pupils, in collaboration with parents, with knowledge and skills that

- Prepares them for further education and makes them want to learn more
- Make them familiar* with Danish culture and history
- Gives them an understanding of other countries and cultures
- Helps them understand how humans and nature influence* each other.

Furthermore, the aim of primary school is for each individual student to develop in a comprehensive manner. This means, among other things, that the student must not only have academic knowledge, but must also develop personally and socially.

Primary school must also teach children to cooperate. The teaching is therefore sometimes organised in such a way that the pupils learn to work together in groups and to solve problems through cooperation. It may also include* excursions and Camp schools together with the teachers in the lessons. Here the children learn new ways of collaborating and being with each other.

Students must also learn to think critically and independently. They must learn to argue for their opinions. Therefore, in most subjects, we work with some form of Teaching that ensures that students can discuss the academic material they are learning and understand it in relation to their everyday lives.

The primary school must prepare students to have shared responsibility, rights and duties in a society with freedom and democracy*. The school must therefore be characterized* by freedom of thought*, equality* and democracy. It is often in the subjects of history, Danish and social studies that students are taught this.

At every school with 5th grade or higher, students have the right to form a student council. A student council consists of at least one student from each class. The student council primarily helps decide on matters that have to do with the students' own school day, such as food in the canteen. The school can also ask the student council what it thinks.

about major decisions at the school. At least two representatives from the students also sit on the school board*.

Common goals are set for what students should learn in all subjects, and teaching is planned with a view to students achieving the goals. Teachers often work together in teams, i.e. they work together in groups. A team can, for example, work together on how teaching in certain classes should be, or how to solve problems in teaching.

Students are usually divided into classes, and each class has one or more class teachers who are responsible for contact with students, parents, other teachers in the class and the school management. In some schools, the class teacher changes when students reach the middle school level and again in the final year of school. However, students often have the same classmates throughout their school years.

Each student from kindergarten through 9th grade also has a report card, which is the teacher's assessment of how the student is performing academically in a subject. The class teacher can also assess how the student is doing socially, i.e. how the student functions with the other students and with the teachers. In the report book, the teacher also describes what the student should focus on in the coming year.

If a student needs support for more than nine teaching hours per week, the student must be offered special education, where the student is, for example, taught together with other students who may need to be taught in a different way than that used in the class. The special education must be organized so that the students go through the same subjects and topics as their classes.

Students must generally be taught in a regular class and can only be placed in a special class if they have a special need.

From grade 0 (kindergarten) to grade 7, children do not receive grades in elementary school. However, from grade 8 onwards, students receive grades in a number of subjects at least twice a year. After grade 9, students take exams in many subjects. After 10th grade, students can also take exams in several subjects. The exams can be both oral and written.

Students are given grades. The grading scale used in Denmark is called the 7-point scale. The highest grade is 12 and the lowest grade is -3. The 7-point scale is used throughout the Danish education system.

SCHOOL-HOME COLLABORATION

The collaboration between school and home is an important part of the work in primary school. The goal of the collaboration is to support the student's learning and well-being. Studies of learning show that students learn better when they talk at home about what they are learning at school and when the school ensures that parents are aware of what is happening at school.

SCHOOL-HOME CONVERSATIONS

In most schools, parents are invited to a meeting at least once a year. with the child's teachers. This is called school-home conversations.

In the older grades, the students are usually present at the conversation. During the school-home conversation, the child's teacher or teachers talk to the parents and possibly the child about

- How the child feels socially in class
- What is the child's academic level?
- The student plan and what to focus on in the coming months
- How parents can help if there are problems

A school-home conversation usually lasts about 15 minutes.

Some schools have employed a school-home counselor, who can be a teacher or an educator. The school-home counselor's task is to strengthen* dialogue and cooperation between the school and the home in order to strengthen the students academically and socially.

PARENT MEETINGS AND CLASS COUNCIL

Parent-teacher meetings in the classroom are held at most schools once or twice a year. For example, teachers can talk about how they have planned the school year and how the class works. At the parent-teacher meetings, parents can also discuss what rules they want to apply in the class, for example about birthdays, packed lunches or well-being* in the class.

At parent meetings, you can also choose contact parents or a class council. A class council has several tasks. It can arrange class parties or summer camps; it can deal with social problems in the classroom if there are children who are being teased; or it can ensure that, for example, criticism of conditions at the school is forwarded to the school board.

SCHOOL BOARDS

All primary schools must have a school board. A school board consists of representatives of the parents, staff and students, and possibly up to two representatives from the local business community, local youth education institutions or local associations. The parents constitute the majority of the school board.

The school board determines, among other things, how parental cooperation should take place. The school board can also help decide how the money for education should be spent.

THE FREE PRIMARY SCHOOLS AND AFTER SCHOOLS

Most of the children in a year group attend primary school. Some of the children attend independent schools. primary schools (e.g. religious independent schools or private schools).

FREE PRIMARY SCHOOLS

Independent primary schools are independent institutions. They can also be schools that work with a specific pedagogy or teaching method or build on a specific religious basis. For example, you can combine the hours in the different subjects so that you have Danish in one period, German in another period and mathematics in a third. The teaching in the independent primary schools must be in line with what is generally required in the primary school.

You usually have to pay to have your child attend a free primary school. Most free Primary schools receive financial support from the public sector. Schools must also prepare students to live in a society like the Danish one with freedom and democracy.

AFTER-SCHOOLS

In the 8th, 9th or 10th grade, young people can choose to attend further education. A further education is a school where students live and receive education.

At the secondary schools, students have regular subjects such as Danish, English, mathematics and physical education. They can also choose a number of optional subjects, such as drama, music, visual arts, IT or cooking. The optional subjects vary from school to school, and they are often creative or practical subjects. Many young people choose to go to secondary school to try something new, make new classmates and try to move away from home for a period of time and perhaps think about which youth education they want to continue with.

It costs money to attend a continuing education program. However, it is possible to receive financial support for a stay under special circumstances.



Fact sheet 2: **Training**

Education is very important, as most jobs in the Danish labor market requires that you have an education. Danish society is often called a knowledge society. This means that more and more people have jobs where knowledge is the most important resource*. That is why education plays a crucial* role for young people and adults. Education is usually free in Denmark.

This fact sheet is about:

- Youth education
- Higher education
- Adult and continuing education

YOUTH TRAINING

After primary school, the vast majority of young people choose to apply for a youth education. There are two different types of youth education: upper secondary education and vocational education. There are also some education programs that can prepare young people for these education programs, or help young people on their way in life. These include, for example, FGU (preparatory basic education) and STU (specially designed youth education).

FGU is for young people under 25 years of age who are not currently enrolled in or have completed a youth education, who do not have a job, and who need special preparatory efforts to complete a youth education or get a job. FGU has room for young people to be different. The purpose of FGU is to prepare students to take a youth education or a job.

STU is for young people under 25 years of age with special needs who cannot take a youth education. The purpose is that young people who are developmentally disabled or have other special needs become as prepared as possible for adult life and perhaps also for further education or a job. STU does not in itself provide access to other education.

HIGH SCHOOL EDUCATION

Upper secondary education prepares young people in particular for higher education, and teaching usually takes place at upper secondary schools and vocational schools.

At public high schools, tuition is free. There are four different upper secondary education:

- Education for the general high school leaving exam (stx)
- The education for the commercial high school diploma (hhx)
- The education for the technical high school diploma (htx)
- The education for the hf exam (hf)

The STX, HHX and HTX programmes last three years and the HF programme lasts two years. Young people who have completed primary school with the 9th grade exam can be admitted here*. All four upper secondary education programmes conclude with an exam that grants admission* for higher education.

At STX, the subjects that the young people have studied in primary school are largely continued, such as language, history, mathematics, social studies, physics, chemistry and biology. The education ends with a high school diploma.

At HF, you have largely the same subjects as in general upper secondary school. The HF exam is specifically aimed at short and medium-term higher education programmes at vocational colleges and vocational academies. The programme concludes with a hf exam.

At hhx, there is teaching in subjects related to commerce, such as economics, marketing* and international economics. But there is also teaching in, for example, languages, mathematics and social studies. The teaching usually takes place at a commercial high school. The education is concluded with a commercial matriculation examination.

At HTX, there is teaching in natural science and technology subjects. But there is also teaching in, for example, language and mathematics. The teaching usually takes place at a technical high school. The education ends with a technical student exam.

VOCATIONAL TRAINING PROGRAMS

After primary school, you can also choose a vocational education. There are more than 100 different vocational education programs that offer the opportunity for jobs as a skilled worker or further education. The many vocational education programs are aimed at all professions in Denmark, for example within four main areas: education and pedagogy

- Office, trade and business services
- Food, agriculture and experiences
- Technology, construction and transportation
- Health, care and education



The educations lead to jobs such as industrial technician, mechanic, plumber, electrician, social and health assistant, educational assistant, chef, blacksmith, shop assistant, bricklayer, media graphic designer, hairdresser, farmer and much more.

A vocational education consists of a basic course at a vocational school and a main course. The main course combines school education at a vocational school with practical training. The training is usually given in a company. When you have a training agreement with a company, you get paid both during the training and during school hours. A vocational education can take between 1½ and 5½ years, depending on the type of education. If students cannot find an apprenticeship

After the basic course, in most cases they can receive training at a school training center. In this case, they do not receive a salary, but a school training allowance.

The vocational education and training programs have three tracks: one for young people (eud), one for adults over 25 (euv) and in combination with the upper secondary school leaving exam (eux). With an eux, you get a vocational education and training program with built-in upper secondary school leaving exam subjects. This means that with a completed eux, you get both a journeyman's certificate with direct access to a job (e.g. as an electrician) and a vocational school leaving exam.

HIGHER EDUCATION

Most young people who have completed upper secondary education continue on to higher education. The same goes for some young people from vocational education. Most higher education is free for citizens in Denmark and the EU.

The individual programs have specific admission requirements. For example, there may be requirements* that you have taken certain subjects in your upper secondary education, or that you have a certain grade point average.

Higher education can be taken at vocational academies, vocational colleges, maritime educational institutions, higher education institutions, etc. artistic educational institutions and at universities.

BUSINESS ACADEMIES

At a vocational academy, you can, among other things, take a vocational academy education, where you are trained for a specific job or to work in a specific industry. This could be, for example, a job as a laboratory technician, an electrician or a job in a bank. The teaching is combined with an internship. A vocational academy education typically takes about two years. There are seven vocational academies in Denmark.

UNIVERSITY COLLEGES

At vocational colleges, you can take a professional bachelor's degree, which trains you for a specific job. Most professional bachelors go on to work in the public sector, for example as a primary school teacher, midwife, nurse, social worker, educator or physiotherapist. But you can also become a journalist or work in communications, for example.

A professional bachelor's degree program usually takes three to four years. Includes internship in these programs. There are seven university colleges in Denmark.



UNIVERSITIES

At universities, you can take a long higher education, including bachelor's and master's degrees. This can be in health sciences (e.g. medicine), social sciences (e.g. law or economics), humanities (e.g. language or history), natural sciences (e.g. biology, physics or chemistry), arts (e.g. design) or technical sciences (e.g. engineering). A bachelor's degree typically takes about three years, and a subsequent master's degree typically takes about two years. There are eight universities in Denmark.

FINANCIAL SUPPORT IN CONNECTION WITH EDUCATION

The state can provide financial support if you are studying for a degree. This support is colloquially called SU, which is an abbreviation for State Education Support. You can receive SU when you are enrolled in a degree program that is approved for SU, and if you meet the conditions for receiving SU. For example, you are actively studying and do not earn too much on the side. If you are not a Danish citizen, you can apply to the Danish Agency for Higher Education and Research to receive the same financial support as Danish citizens.

ADULT AND CONTINUING EDUCATION

There is a long tradition of continuing education in Denmark. It is often said that lifelong learning (learning throughout life) is important. People who already have an education and work experience have many opportunities to further their education. For example, they can take a diploma, which is a part-time* education where the academic level corresponds to a bachelor's degree. The education typically takes three years part-time, and you pay to attend the education. Many schools that offer higher education have courses where it is possible to study one subject at a time.

Adults can also take short AMU courses. AMU stands for labour market training and is a short-term course primarily aimed at skilled and unskilled workers. There are many different labour market training courses within trade, administration and management, health, construction/construction, agriculture, kitchen/restaurant, metal industry, transport etc.

For example, if an adult has problems with spelling, reading or arithmetic, he or she can take FVU courses at VUC (adult education centres). You must normally be 25 years of age to be admitted to FVU.

If an adult is dyslexic*, the person can take dyslexia classes (OBU courses) at VUC. The purpose of OBU is to give the person better opportunities to cope in situations where they have to read or write.

You must normally be 25 years of age to be admitted to OBU.

At VUC, adults can also take Avu courses (general adult education).

The purpose is to give adults better opportunities for further education and for active participation in a democratic society.

society. The subjects at avu are single subjects at primary school level, e.g. English, Danish, German or mathematics. You can take one or more subjects at a time. There are different levels, and the highest level (D) provides good academic context for the upper secondary school leaving examination. As a general rule, you must be 25 years of age to be admitted to Avu.



Fact sheet 3:

Daycare

It has been a political goal in Denmark since the 1960s to give parents the opportunity to have their children looked after outside the home in nurseries and kindergartens, because the aim was to get women into the labour market. Today, both parents usually work outside the home. The vast majority of younger children go to

therefore in nursery school, kindergarten or day care. Most children between three and five years are cared for outside the home. Common to all types of care is that the educational work must promote* children's well-being*, development and learning.

All children have the right to a place in a day care facility. The municipalities are responsible for the day care facilities, but the types of facilities available vary from municipality to municipality. The most common are crèche, kindergarten and day care. The municipality pays part of the cost, while the parents pay the remaining part. However, if, for example, the parents' income is low or the child is a single parent, it is possible to apply for additional financial support from the municipality.

This fact sheet is about:

- Nursery
- Daycare
- Kindergarten
- After-school and leisure club

CRADLE

A nursery is for children from about six months to about three years. The staff in nurseries (the educators) must, among other things, ensure that the individual child thrives, learns and develops, and they must also contribute to the children receiving care and a good and safe upbringing. The staff must work with plans for the pedagogical work in the nursery. Through this, children must, among other things, learn to be together with each other and to be considerate. The children must also be supported in developing their language, and this is done, for example, by talking to them, singing songs and reading books to them. The educators also help the children to develop their bodies, for example, by running, dancing, drawing and jumping. They do this both inside the nursery and outside, for example, on the playground.

DAY CARE

Not all young children go to nursery. Some go to daycare. A daycare is typically for children from about six months to about three years. In a daycare, the child is cared for by a daycare worker together with two to four other children in the daycare worker's private home. For

To be approved by the municipality as a daycare provider, you must comply with certain requirements* regarding, among other things, food, hygiene, health and cleaning. For example, smoking is not allowed in the parts of the daycare center where the children stay.

Like the nursery, the daycare must work with plans for the pedagogical work, and many of the activities can be the same as in the nursery.

KINDERGARTEN

A kindergarten is for children from about three years old to six years old. In the kindergarten, plans for the pedagogical work must also be worked on. For example, the teachers teach the children how to play together and how to resolve disagreements with each other. In the kindergarten, stories are also read and songs are sung, both to develop language, but also to create a community among the children. In many kindergartens, the traditional Christian holidays* play a large role, such as Christmas and Easter. In this connection, the institution is decorated, and the children help draw and cut decorations.

You also learn about other traditions and religious holidays than the Christian ones, such as Eid* or Chinese New Year. There is typically less staff in a kindergarten than in a daycare center because the children are older and can do more things themselves.



AFTER-SALES AND LEISURE CLUB

SFO is an abbreviation for SkoleFritidsOrdning. SFO is a place where children in primary school can be looked after before or after school by educators. In the SFO there are some common activities for all the children. This can be, for example, playing music and theatre, painting, sewing or drawing, but it can also be sports activities such as swimming, football or ice skating. For older children, there are in many municipalities

club offers and other leisure activities. Club offers can, for example, be an offer for older children that they can use after school. One of the goals of club offers is to teach older children to cooperate and join in with other young people.

In the club you can meet and play everything from football to music. In some places there are offers for young people to go to clubs in the evening. Here you can watch movies, play games, etc. music or playing games together. Club offers should give older children and young people ideas about what to do in their free time, so that they can better plan their free time themselves.



PARENTAL COOPERATION

It is important that there is good contact between parents and educators in the institution. This is very important for whether the child is doing well. The educators can tell the parents about what is happening in the daily life in the institution. And the parents can tell the educators about how the child is doing at home.

Many institutions also hold parent meetings. Here, parents can find out more about what is happening in the institution. They can also make suggestions for improvements*. Parents also elect representatives to the parent board.

The parent council has influence* on, for example, the institution's financial arrangements and activities for the children.

Fact sheet 4:

The Danish labor market

This fact sheet is about:

- How the Danish labor market works
- Flexicurity
- Collective agreements
- Trade unions
- When you get a job
- Salary
- Working hours
- Vacation
- Maternity leave, paternity leave and parental leave
- Democracy in the workplace
- Rules for firing
- If you lose your job
- Being self-employed

In some countries, there is a tradition that it is mostly the parliament and the government that decide how the labor market should function. But that is not the case in Denmark. Here, only a few rules about employment relationships are determined in legislation. Most rules are agreed between the social partners – the trade unions and the employers' organizations. This system dates back to 1899.

The two parties meet and negotiate with each other to enter into collective agreements*. These are agreements about what rules for wages, working hours, etc. will apply during the agreement period (which usually lasts two years).

Both parties must abide by the agreement, and there is a "peace obligation" – no strikes or lockouts as long as the agreement is in force. There is a whole special system outside the ordinary courts to resolve violations (Labour Court and professional arbitration courts*).

If they cannot agree on a collective agreement, the two parties have different options: For example, the unions can organize strikes. This means that members stop work until an agreement is reached.

For example, employers can lock out employees who are members of a union. This means that employees who are members of a union are not allowed to come to work until a collective agreement has been reached. Employers do not pay wages to employees who are on strike or to employees who are affected by a lockout. However, most often the parties agree on a collective agreement without resorting to a strike or lockout.

In total, slightly more than three out of four citizens in Denmark between the ages of 15 and 64 have a work. Almost equal numbers of men and women work.

FLEXICURITY

Compared to other countries, it is relatively easy to hire and fire people in Denmark. For example, it is easy for employers to hire new employees during a period when there is a lot of work in the company. Conversely, it is also easy to fire employees when there is not so much work. This makes it very flexible for employers to plan their work. In return, employees are financially secure because they can receive financial support if they are fired. Normally, as unemployed, they can receive unemployment benefits (unemployment benefits) if they are a member of an unemployment fund (a-kasse). If they are not a member of an unemployment fund, they can often get cash assistance by contacting the municipality. Unlike unemployment benefits, however, it depends on the income of the person and their spouse, and savings or other assets (e.g. cars or summer houses) must be used up before you can receive help. In addition, many people can also use a period of unemployment for further training.



COLLECTIVE AGREEMENTS

In Denmark, most conditions in the labor market are determined by extensive* agreements between trade unions and employers' associations. These agreements are called collective* agreements. The collective agreements regulate* most conditions in the labor market, such as wages, working hours, sick pay and maternity leave as well as pension and the right to further education.

As mentioned, in Denmark, the state does not interfere as much in matters related to the labor market as the state does in many other countries.

It is not the Danish Parliament that determines, for example, the weekly working hours. Nor does the Danish Parliament decide that there should be a statutory minimum wage in the Danish labour market. That depends on the collective agreements. That many

Conditions in the labour market are determined by the social partners and not by the Folketinget, which is often called the 'Danish model'. Because the collective agreements cover such a large part of the labour market and have an impact on the rest, they are largely as comprehensive as if they had been adopted by law.

However, it happens that the state determines the conditions in the labor market through legislation. For example, five weeks of vacation are determined by law.

It also happens that the state intervenes if employers and employees' organizations cannot agree when negotiating new collective agreements. When the two parties cannot agree, it can lead to long-term strikes or lockouts. There have been several cases in Denmark where

The Danish Parliament has stopped a strike or lockout by passing a law that determines the collective agreement. This happened, for example, in 2021, when many nurses went on strike, and where the Danish Parliament finally, after the strike had lasted for over two months, decided which agreement should apply.



However, collective agreements do not cover* all areas. For example, many highly educated people employed in the private sector, such as engineers, economists and lawyers, are not covered* by collective agreements and must therefore typically* negotiate their own pay and employment terms when they are hired. This also applies to areas within, for example, the restaurant industry – traditionally also agriculture.

TRADE ASSOCIATIONS

Trade unions take care of their members' professional interests in the workplace. This applies to, for example, pay and working conditions as well as cooperation with management. In this way, trade unions help ensure fair wages and working conditions. Most employees in Denmark are members of a trade union. It costs money to be a member of a trade union. You pay a membership fee*.

In Denmark, there is a long tradition of a large proportion of employees being members of a trade union. In Denmark, around two out of three employees are now members of a trade union. In 1990, the proportion was as high as around five out of six, so it has declined considerably.

Trade unions are usually divided by profession and area of work. For example, some trade unions are for craftsmen, while others are for shop staff or office workers. Most people choose a trade union that covers* their profession and the area they work in.

But it is not a requirement to be a member of a trade union. It is voluntary.

Neither the employer nor the colleagues may force an employee to be a member of a trade union or to be a member of a particular trade union. The employer may not fire an employee because he or she joins or leaves a trade union. And when hiring, an employer may not attach importance* to whether the applicant is a member of a trade union.

THREE MAJOR TRADE ASSOCIATIONS



The HK union primarily represents people who work in retail or offices. These can include store employees, laboratory technicians, secretaries, receptionists and clinic assistants.



FOA primarily represents people employed in home care, SOSU assistants, firefighters, canteen staff, etc.



3F typically represents employees in industry and employees working in transportation and construction – e.g. welders, drivers, bricklayers and carpenters – but also cleaners and other unskilled workers.

TRUSTEES AND WORKING ENVIRONMENT PRESENTATIVES

The members of a trade union elect one or more shop stewards at each workplace. This is typically the case in workplaces with more than ten employees. Shop stewards are elected from among the employees at a meeting where the employer is not present. Shop stewards have special protection against being fired or transferred to another workplace.

Shop stewards represent employees towards management, for example in connection with salary negotiations. Employees can also receive advice and guidance from the shop steward, for example about overtime or the relationship with management. A shop steward – or colleagues at the workplace – cannot, according to the law, force* people to be members of a particular trade union or to be members of a trade union.

The meetings of a trade union at the workplace are called “club meetings”. All members of the trade union at the workplace can attend these meetings. At the club meetings, various matters at the workplace are discussed, such as wages or salary supplements, and it is also here that shop stewards are elected. All members can stand* for election as shop steward. If several people stand, a vote is taken on who they should be. The employees usually also elect a work environment representative.

The occupational health and safety representative must monitor the physical and mental working environment and be aware of whether the employees have the right safety equipment, for example. This could be a mask if you are working with paint, or a helmet if you are working on a construction site. If the employer has not ensured that safety is in order, the occupational health and safety representative can intervene*. Other examples of a poor physical working environment include too much noise, too hot or too cold indoor climate, too little light, and bad chairs that can give employees in an office back pain.

Mental work environment is about whether employees thrive* when they go to work. And a poor mental work environment can therefore be if there are employees who have been subjected to bullying or harassment or are stressed* by going to work.

WHEN YOU GET A JOB

The law states that anyone who works more than three hours a week for more than four weeks is must have a certificate of employment* no later than one month after being hired.

The employment certificate states, for example:

- What kind of work to do
- When to start
- How many hours should you work per week?
- What you get in salary and any bonuses
- Whether you are entitled to paid vacation
- Which collective agreement you are covered by*
- How long notice* the employer must give when firing

When applying for a job, the employer may not ask about your health and number of sick days in previous jobs, or whether you are pregnant or planning to have children.

However, the employer may ask about health conditions that are important for the work you are going to do. For example, the employer may ask whether you have had a bad back if you are applying for a job in the construction industry. Conversely, the person applying for the job has a duty to provide information about health conditions that may be important for the job. The employer may also not ask about people's religion when applying for a job.

PAY

For employees in the public sector, salaries are typically agreed centrally between the trade unions and the public employers (state, region and municipality).

WORKING HOURS

If you have a regular paid job in a private company or in the public sector, the most common is working hours of 37 hours per week.

When working in shifts and on permanent night shifts, working hours are often slightly shorter. The length of working hours is agreed upon through collective bargaining between employee and employer organizations.

It is called “reduced hours” or “part-time” if you work less than the regular working hours of normally 37 hours a week. In some areas, part-time work is common, for example among nurses or shop employees. There are more women

than men who work part-time.



You can always ask to work reduced hours. But it is the employer who decides whether you can be allowed to do so. Conversely, the employer cannot demand* that you work part-time.

HOLIDAY

As an employee, you are entitled to paid vacation. You earn approximately two vacation days for each month you are employed, and the vacation can be taken the following month.

You are therefore entitled to five weeks of paid vacation if you have worked for a full year.

Some are also entitled to a sixth week of vacation. It depends on your collective agreement or employment certificate*.

Normally, you agree with your employer when you will take your vacation. Normally, you are entitled to three weeks of vacation in a row between May 1 and September 30.

When you get a new job, you can take the vacation you have earned from a previous employer if you have not had time to take it.

DEMOCRACY IN THE WORKPLACE

In larger workplaces, there must be a works council where representatives from management and employee representatives discuss various issues.

conditions in the workplace. The employees' union representatives are members of the cooperation committee.

In larger workplaces, a working environment representative must also be elected who, in collaboration with management, takes care of the working environment, i.e. the physical and mental safety and health of employees in the workplace.

The occupational health and safety representative is elected by the employees at a meeting in which management does not participate. Like shop stewards, occupational health and safety representatives are protected in their employment.

This means that the employer cannot fire a health and safety representative because the employer and the health and safety representative disagree about the working environment.

Much of the co-determination in workplaces in Denmark takes place informally*. If employees have something they are unhappy with or want to suggest, they usually talk to their immediate superior about it. This is more common in Denmark than in the most other countries.

RULES FOR FIRING

In most cases, an employer must have a factual* and real reason to fire an employee. employee, e.g. that the employee is not suitable for the job, that there are cooperation problems, or that there are conditions in the company that require dismissal, e.g. cost savings. If there is a shop steward at the workplace, the employer must often talk to him or her about the dismissal*.

An employer may not dismiss an employee on the basis of gender, race, colour, religion or belief, political opinion, sexual orientation, age, disability or national, social or ethnic origin. It is also not permitted to dismiss people on the basis of pregnancy or maternity leave.

An employee may not be fired because the employee chooses not to be a member of a trade union, or because the employee joins a trade union. An employee may not be fired because he or she is not a member of the same trade union as colleagues at a workplace, nor may the employer require membership of a particular trade union.

IF YOU LOSE YOUR JOB

In Denmark, it is voluntary whether you want to insure yourself financially in the event of unemployment. You are not normally financially insured in the event of unemployment unless you are a member of an unemployment fund. Unemployment funds are private associations, and most people are members of an unemployment fund.

The unemployment fund is an insurance scheme that protects against the financial consequences* of unemployment. The individual pays a contribution*, and

In return, you can generally receive support, i.e. unemployment benefits, if you become unemployed. The unemployment funds are financially supported by the state, so part of the unemployment benefits is paid not only from the quota, but also from public funds, i.e. via taxes. Most unemployment insurance funds are linked to a trade union, but you can be a member of an unemployment fund, even if you are not a member of a trade union. There are also unemployment funds that are not linked to specific trade unions.

If you are a member of an unemployment fund, you are normally entitled to unemployment benefits for a period of time if you lose your job. However, you must be available for the labour market. This means, among other things, that you must say yes if you are offered a job and that you must actively look for a job. As a member of an unemployment fund, you will be invited* to meetings at the unemployment fund when you have registered as unemployed. When you have registered as unemployed, you must also fill in various information about the jobs you are applying for and the experience, education and skills you have.

The unemployment insurance fund and the unemployed person fill out a digital job plan called "My Plan" together. "My Plan" contains, among other things, information on how to get back to work, as well as meetings and agreements that are about the specific unemployed person's job search. When a member of an unemployment fund has been unemployed for three months, the job center takes over the responsibility for getting the member back to work. After that, it is also the job center that continuously updates "My Plan".

In order to receive unemployment benefits, you are obliged to comply with the job plan, i.e. participate in initiatives (e.g. internships at companies) and interviews that the job center and unemployment insurance fund require.

If you lose your job but are not a member of an unemployment fund, you can get financial help from the municipality. This can be, for example, educational assistance or cash assistance. However, this requires that you meet certain conditions - for example, that you cannot work for yourself or be supported by your spouse. These benefits are usually lower than unemployment benefits. And just like with unemployment benefits, you get a "My Plan", and you have a duty to be available to the labor market and a duty to participate in the efforts that the municipality offers.

BEING SELF-EMPLOYED

If you want to be self-employed, you need to register with the Danish Business Authority via its website and provide a few details. You can seek advice on what it's like to work as a self-employed person from a growth consultant who has extensive experience in helping people start a business.

You can also contact your local business advisor in your municipality. There are also municipal courses for people who want to be self-employed. In these courses you can learn something about economics, accounting or personnel management. As a self-employed person, you are obliged to keep accounts, and the company's profit* or loss* must be declared* to SKAT.

Fact sheet 5:

Danish

business community

The Danish business community consists of various sectors.

This fact sheet covers:

- Danish agriculture
- Danish industry
- Danish shipping
- Danish services
- Denmark's foreign trade

DANISH AGRICULTURE

Denmark has traditionally been an agricultural country with large exports* of food.

Until 1960, there were almost 200,000 independent farmers. In contrast to many countries, Denmark was dominated by medium-sized farms. This was the background for an unusually strong and well-organized peasantry, which itself built up and owned the food industry. Since 1960, the number of farms has fallen by about 80 percent, and there are only about 10,000 full-time farmers left. Small farmers disappeared, and many farms have been merged.

Today, farms are very large and highly efficient. About 11 percent of the agricultural area is farmed organically. Denmark still has a large food industry. From the 1880s, farmers established numerous small independent dairies and slaughterhouses. These were cooperatives, owned by the farmers.

In the cooperatives, each farmer has one vote, regardless of how much milk or how many animals they delivered. The vast majority of dairies and slaughterhouses are now closed together in large groups, Arla and Danish Crown respectively.

They export all over the world. But they are still cooperatives.

Today, Arla extends beyond Denmark's borders. In 2000, the Danish and Swedish dairies were merged, and the expansion has continued. Arla is today owned by almost 10,000 farmers from seven countries: Denmark, Sweden, Germany, the Netherlands, Belgium and Luxembourg, as well as the United Kingdom. In Denmark and Sweden, most dairy farmers are involved. In Germany, Arla is among the three largest. In 2024, Arla was the world's 7th largest dairy group.

DANISH INDUSTRY

Danish industry has traditionally been characterized by many small and medium-sized companies. Denmark has not had many large industrial companies, compared to most other countries.

countries in Western Europe. Small and medium-sized enterprises have been good at finding niches* and quick to adapt. But the big companies have become bigger. Denmark has many companies that are known all over the world. The most famous is probably LEGO, which manufactures building blocks for children in almost every country.



Danish industry is spread across many areas. Denmark has many large pharmaceutical companies*, of which Novo Nordisk, which manufactures insulin for patients with diabetes, is one of the giants*.

Denmark also manufactures over a third of the world's hearing aids. The three largest Danish manufacturers GN Store Nord (GN Resound), William Demant (Oticon) and Widex make up three of the five largest hearing aid manufacturers in the world. Denmark is one of the world's leading countries in renewable energy and energy savings.

Denmark is the homeland of the modern wind turbine industry, where the so-called Gedser mill (from 1957) and the Tvind mill (built 1975-78) inspired an entire grassroots movement of small wind turbine manufacturers from the late 1970s onwards.

The world's largest wind turbine manufacturer (2024) – Vestas – is located in Denmark. Overall, Denmark has a strong position when it comes to "green" production, including energy savings, waste management, recycling, etc.

Even international companies include Rockwool (insulation), Grundfos (pumps, etc.), Danfoss (thermostats) and Velux (windows).

DENMARK'S FOREIGN TRADE

Denmark has a very open economy, where trade with foreign countries – not least neighboring countries – plays a very large role. Germany is the country from which Denmark imports* the most, and the USA is the country to which Denmark exports* the most. Overall, however, exports* to other EU countries are clearly larger than to the USA.

In 2024, Denmark's seven largest trading partners were as follows (in their share of the value of Denmark's total foreign trade (imports* and exports)).

USA (15.0 percent), Germany (12.8 percent), Sweden (7.7 percent), Netherlands (5.5 percent), Great Britain (5.0 percent), China (4.7 percent) and Norway (3.9 percent).

DANISH SHIPPING

Denmark is also an important maritime nation with several large shipping companies. Maersk is one of the world's two largest container shipping companies.

Denmark has a large oil production relative to its size and was for many years the only EU country to export more oil than it imported. However, production has fallen sharply since its peak in the mid-00s, and the plan is to stop it completely by 2050.



DANISH SERVICES

A number of Danish companies are also strong when it comes to services.

ISS has around half a million employees worldwide working in cleaning, property services, security, etc. But a number of Danish architectural firms are also world-renowned, just as many engineering firms are involved in consulting worldwide.

Skilled, well-educated employees are one important source of Danish companies' success. is doing well. Good management is another. This also includes the fact that Danish companies, more than in most countries, are characterized by giving the individual employee responsibility for his or her own area of work. It is expected that the employee not only does what is said, but also takes responsibility and initiative himself, of course in agreement with the manager.

Fact sheet 6:

The Danish welfare society

The welfare society* in Denmark is based on a kind of mutual agreement between citizens and the state. On the one hand, citizens contribute* by having those citizens who can work and pay taxes. On the other hand, the public sector* is a safety net for citizens, ensuring help for those who cannot fend for themselves.

The state therefore takes a great responsibility for the welfare of its citizens. This means that the state is co-responsible for ensuring that citizens feel safe and that they can thrive. In this way, the state helps to ensure that citizens, for example:

- can get free schooling and education
- can get help during illness
- can get help if they lose their job
- can get help if they have or develop a disability
- can get help when they get older

Conversely, citizens have a responsibility to contribute* financially to the welfare state by working and paying taxes. In this way, money is provided for welfare via the tax system.

In other words, the principle of the Danish welfare society is that everyone who can should contribute to welfare, and that everyone who needs it can receive help from the public sector regardless of their connection to the labor market.

This fact sheet is about:

- Welfare in many parts of citizens' lives
- The money for welfare – where does it come from?

WELFARE IN MANY PARTS OF CITIZENS' LIVES

In the Danish form of welfare society, the public sector takes care of many tasks within, for example, health, education and the social area. The public sector therefore takes on a great responsibility for the welfare of citizens. In this way, the public sector helps to ensure that for example, citizens can receive free schooling and education, medical care and assistance if they cannot support themselves.

Welfare costs are paid for, among other things, through taxes.



Citizens in Denmark have equal access to most public services*. Everyone, regardless of income, for example, has the opportunity to receive free medical care. Some benefits are only given to people without income or assets, e.g. cash benefits, or to people with a low income, e.g. housing benefit. In some areas, people with particularly low incomes can get help from the municipality to pay a specific expense, e.g. part of the dental bill.

Children

The public sector provides, for example, crèches, kindergartens and daycare so that children can be day care while their parents work. It is usually not free to have a child looked after. You usually have to pay part of the costs yourself.

Parents can receive a 'child check' (child and youth benefit) if they have children under the age of 18. Parents with particularly high incomes receive a smaller benefit or no benefit at all, depending on their income. Special rules apply to foreigners.



School

Children have the right to attend primary school for free. And after primary school, young people have the opportunity to take a free youth education (e.g. at a vocational school or a high school). Later, they can take a free higher education (e.g. at a university or a university college). Normally, you have the opportunity to get financial support when you study. It is called State Education Support (SU). SU is high in Denmark compared to what you can get as support for education in most other countries.

The parents are with

In Denmark, there is a long tradition of parents being active participants in what happens in schools and daycare institutions. There are school boards with parent representatives in primary schools, and there are usually parent boards in daycare institutions. This is stated in the law. But in addition, parents' councils or similar are usually elected in the individual school classes - a job that typically takes place in turns. Parents are expected to take on this task, and to show up.

at parent meetings, etc. This is also the explanation why parents of children in schools and daycare institutions in Denmark feel that they have have a significant impact on what happens in school.

Financial help if you are not working

For citizens who are not in work, there are various forms of financial support. assistance from the public.

If you are sick for a long time, it is possible to receive sickness benefits if you have earned the right to it either by working or as a member of an unemployment fund. If you are unable to support yourself because your working capacity is limited, the solution may be, for example, a flex job, where you work and earn a lot. themselves and receive the rest in public benefits. If you have a permanent and significant disability ability to work, you can receive early retirement.

When you get older, you have the opportunity to receive a state pension. The purpose of the state pension is to enable older people to support themselves when they no longer work. In 2025, you can receive a state pension from the age of 67. The age limit for receiving a state pension will be gradually raised as the population lives longer.

As a general rule, you must be a Danish citizen, have permanent residence in Denmark and have lived in Denmark for at least three years from the age of 15 to the age of retirement to be entitled to an early retirement pension or a state pension. If you have lived in the country for less than 40 years, you will receive a pension in proportion to the number of years you have lived here. Special rules apply to people who live abroad or are EU citizens or refugees. Many pensioners receive a pension in addition to the state pension, this is because they have paid into pension schemes (labour market pension) in connection with their work.

Many people also have voluntary pension plans that they pay into themselves when they can. These can be, for example, pension plans that you agree on with your bank or insurance company.



Housing

If you live in a rented house and have a low income, you may in some cases be eligible for housing benefit. Housing benefit is given to cover part of the rent. It depends on, among other things, how much the residents of the house earn, the amount of the rent and the size of the house. Special rules apply to pensioners. Pensioners with low incomes can often be eligible for higher housing benefit.

Health

People residing in Denmark have the right to free treatment from their own general practitioner or specialist. And everyone who is registered in the Central Register of Persons (CPR) receives a health card (the "yellow card"). Almost everyone is now a member of insurance group 1, where they are registered with a specific general practitioner (personal doctor) and must have a referral to a specialist (except for otolaryngologists and ophthalmologists) if medical care is to be free.

If you get sick, you usually first go to your own general practitioner, and treatment is free. The doctor may refer you to a specialist or hospital.

Citizens have the right to free treatment at a public hospital. There are also some private hospitals, where you normally have to pay for the treatment. However, if there is a long waiting time to be treated at the public hospital, you can sometimes times be referred to a private hospital. If you are referred to a private hospital from a public hospital, the treatment at the private hospital is free. However, in some areas, adults must pay some of the costs themselves, such as medical expenses.

Culture

In the cultural field, the public sector provides support in many different ways. The government provides a lot of support to public libraries. Here you can borrow books free. At many libraries you can also borrow or order. The libraries also have books in languages other than Danish. The libraries also have books in languages other than Danish. You can borrow magazines, music, films and computer games. There are free access to computers and the internet, you can read newspapers, and you can get help finding specific information or materials. The libraries have. There are also many useful brochures from organizations and public authorities.

In addition to libraries, there are many other forms of support for culture in Denmark. There is support for associations, e.g. within sports and athletics, and for cultural life, e.g. museums, theaters, festivals and much more.

Transportation

Driving on roads and bridges in Denmark is free. However, on two bridges, the Øresund Bridge and the Great Belt Bridge, you have to pay to drive across.

The public sector provides support for public transport such as buses, trains and ferries.

WELFARE MONEY – WHERE DOES IT COME FROM?

There are large expenses associated with a welfare society like the Danish one, and there is therefore a need for a lot of revenue for the public sector. Denmark is also one of the countries in the world where citizens pay the most in taxes.

The money for welfare comes, among other things, from the tax that citizens pay on their wages. But the tax is not the same for everyone. The principle of tax in Denmark is that the more you earn, the greater part of your salary you have to pay in tax.

People also contribute to the cost of welfare in other ways. The Danish VAT of 25 percent on the goods they buy is among the highest in Europe. There are also special taxes* on many goods, such as cars, petrol, electricity, alcohol, cigarettes, batteries, disposable tableware and supermarket carrier bags.

These taxes are also justified in terms of the environment and health.

In addition, the welfare state receives significant revenue from corporate taxes, property taxes and the return on Danes' pension savings, which are among the largest in the world.



Fact sheet 7:

Family life

It is the responsibility of individual families to make family life work and to provide children with safe conditions to grow up in.

But society has a number of offers that help create a good framework* for family life. For example, you have the right to maternity leave and there are offers of childcare.

At the same time, there are some rules in society that protect the rights of children, men and women. They also apply in the home.

This fact sheet is about:

- The many forms of family life
- Marriage and relationships
- Divorce
- Pregnancy, childbirth and maternity leave
- Children and young people's rights

THE MANY FORMS OF FAMILY LIFE

The most common family form in Denmark consists of a woman and a man and their children together. But family life can also take other forms. And in some families, one or both partners have been married before. Their family may consist of children from both partners' previous marriages and joint children from the current marriage.

There are also families where the parents are not married.

In addition, there are families where the partners are of the same sex, and families where the children are adopted from, for example, Asia. There are small families consisting of single people with their children, and there are families where several generations live together.

MARRIAGE AND RELATIONSHIPS

There are some rules about marriage in Denmark. One of the rules is that it is not allowed to be married to more than one person at a time. When you get married, you sign a document stating that you are not already married.

You can choose whether you want to marry a person of the opposite sex or a person of your own sex. Another rule is that you cannot force* a person to marry against their will. Both parties must want the marriage. You must also be 18 years of age to enter into marriage.



Although you can get married from the age of 18, many people only get married after they have finished their education or have had children.

You can get married at the town hall, in the Danish Church or in recognized religious communities*. If you want to have a religious wedding outside the Danish Church that is also civilly valid (that is, valid according to Danish law), the priest (or religious leader) in the religious community must have authorization*.

In most families in Denmark, both the man and the woman have a job, and they share usually about household chores.

When you are married, you are generally required to provide for each other financially. This means that you cannot receive certain types of financial assistance from the municipality if your spouse has an income or assets* of a certain amount. The same applies to certain benefits for couples living together without being married.

Same-sex couples can marry on an equal basis with other couples, and they can adopt children on the same terms as couples of different sexes.

Parents who are married to each other have joint custody* of their children. Joint custody means that the parents must make important decisions about the child together. This may include, for example, what the child should be called, the child's upbringing, where the child should go to school, what religion the child should have, or where the child should be cared for if the parents work.

Many couples choose to live together – and possibly have children – without being married. If they have children, they have joint custody, among other things, if they make a declaration at the time of the child's birth that they will jointly take care of and be responsible for the child.

DIVORCE

In Denmark, approximately 40 percent of all marriages end in divorce.
If you do not want to continue your marriage, you have the right to obtain a separation.



Separation is a kind of probationary period where you are still married, but usually live separately.
After six months of separation, you have the right to divorce. If the spouses agree, they can

also get divorced immediately without first being separated. Even if there is disagreement, in certain situations you can also get divorced immediately, for example if there is infidelity or violence. After a divorce, both parties have the right to remarry.

If a married couple with children divorce, it is the parents themselves who agree on how they will share responsibility for the children. For example, the parents can agree on which parent the child will live with and how much the child will spend with the other parent.

If they cannot agree, they can get help and advice from the Family Court*.

If the parents still cannot agree, the Family Court or the courts can make a decision on visitation, custody and the child's residence. This

This also applies to parents who have never been married to each other. Many children whose parents do not live together live with their parents in turns.

If the parents move in with a new partner, the children will have a new family.

("grandmother", "grandfather" and perhaps "grandsiblings"). But there are also many who live alone with their children after a divorce.

PREGNANCY, BIRTH AND MATERNITY LEAVE

Pregnant women have the right to a number of examinations by a doctor and a midwife. The purpose of the examinations is to ensure that the woman and the child are well during pregnancy. If problems arise during pregnancy, you can get help at a hospital or health center where a midwife is attached*. The midwife can also tell you about the birth preparation services that are available. For example, in birth preparation, you learn about what happens to the body during pregnancy and how the child develops. You also learn how to make the birth easier.

In Denmark, most people give birth in a hospital, but you can also give birth at home. If

When you give birth in a hospital, it is common for your partner, a family member or a close friend to be present at the birth. After the birth, you can get advice at the hospital, for example about caring for the baby or breastfeeding.

Parents of newborn children receive a visit from a health visitor at home. The health visitor examines the child, monitors its development and guides and advises the parents so that they get the best possible start with their child. The visits are free of charge.



All women have the right to take a period of time off from work before and after giving birth. The father of the child also has the right to take maternity leave. Some workplaces have agreements that employees receive pay during the leave. If you cannot get paid during the leave, you can usually get maternity benefit. You must have earned the right to maternity benefit by working or as a member of an unemployment fund.

In Denmark, a woman has the right to have an abortion before the end of the 18th week of pregnancy. It is the woman who decides for herself whether she wants an abortion. The woman does not need permission from the child's father to have an abortion. In most

In this situation, an abortion will be a decision that the woman and man make together.

However, if the woman is under 18, she must have permission from her parents.

In special cases, she can apply for an abortion without this permission. If a woman wants an abortion, she should contact her doctor, who will refer her to a hospital or clinic where the abortion will be performed. It does not cost anything to have an abortion.

CHILDREN'S AND YOUTH'S RIGHTS

Children and young people have rights just like adults. Children generally have the right to express their opinion on matters that affect their own lives.

For example, if their parents are going to divorce, children have the right to express whether they want to live with their father or mother. There are also rules about how children and young people should be treated.

Some of the most important rules are:

- It is forbidden to hit children.
- Children under 13 are not normally allowed to work for pay outside the home.
- It is forbidden to have sex with young people under 15 years of age.
- Children under 15 years of age cannot be punished
- Young people must be 16 years old before they can buy regular beer.
- Young people must be 18 years of age before they are allowed to buy very strong beer, wine, spirits and cigarettes
- Young people must be 17 years old to get a driver's license.

Most young people who live at home make appointments with their parents what rules should apply to them at home. These could include rules about when they should be home, whether they can go to parties, and whether they can spend the night outside the home. Many young people – both girls and boys – meet in their free time at cafés and discos or hold private parties.

There can be very different opinions on which rules should apply.



in different families. At parent meetings at the children's school, you can agree on some common rules for the children when they are together at, for example, joint parties.

Many young people move away from home when they are 18-20 years old to live alone, with a girlfriend or with other young people.

According to the law, young people are of legal age when they turn 18. This means, among other things, that they have the right to vote, can borrow money from the bank, and that they are responsible for themselves. When you are 18, you can also start receiving SU (State Education Grant) if you are enrolled in an education program where you are entitled to SU.

Although it is forbidden to hit children and young people or to have sexual relations with children, it does happen from time to time that a child is subjected to violence or sexual abuse. If you have knowledge of violence or other abuse against children and young people under the age of 18, you have a duty to contact the municipality and report it. The municipality must then investigate the matter and help the child or young person.

When you turn 17, you can get a driver's license for a regular car and drive unaccompanied* between 5 a.m. and 8 p.m. From 8 p.m. to 5 a.m., 17-year-olds must drive with a companion over the age of 24 who has had a driver's license for at least five years. From the age of 18, you are allowed to drive unaccompanied 24 hours a day.

Fact sheet 8:

Association and leisure life

In Denmark, there is a long tradition of forming associations. Here, people meet around common interests or goals. The associations help to create social communities in Danish society. People with different backgrounds* often meet here. This means that people from different social classes*, with different political views and different ethnic backgrounds come here.

This fact sheet is about:

- Association life in Denmark
- Sports clubs
- Voluntary social work
- Evening schools
- Colleges
- Libraries

ASSOCIATIONAL LIFE IN DENMARK

In Denmark, a very large part of the population is a member of an association. In fact, most citizens in Denmark are members of at least one association. Everyone has the right to form an association in Denmark.

The authorities* do not have to first approve* an association that citizens want to form. This also applies to foreigners. The right to form an association is linked to the freedom of association, assembly and expression. The Constitution states that everyone in Denmark has the right to assemble and express themselves in public.
room legally.

There are many associations, organizations and clubs in Denmark where members meet around common interests and activities. For example, there are sports associations, housing associations, art associations, music associations, immigrant associations, religious associations and associations for people with a particular hobby.

There are also associations that work to improve conditions for specific groups, such as people with disabilities, different patient groups, the elderly or homosexuals. There are also associations that work for a specific political cause, e.g. environment or animal welfare*. And in addition to associations, there are also meeting places, clubs and cultural centers, which are often linked to a residential area. Here, people play cards, discuss, pursue a leisure interest or listen to lectures.

Many citizens are members of an association because they have an interest they want to pursue, and because they want to pursue this interest together with other people. Associations therefore provide a good opportunity to get to know others and form social relationships* and networks. This can also have an impact on employment opportunities. Many people get jobs through their networks, and associations can be a good place to network.

Many of the associations are based on voluntary work. Being a volunteer means that members of the association or others do work for the association without being paid for it. In Denmark, many people do voluntary work regularly.

The associations' financial income comes from, among other things, members' dues*, public subsidies and private actors such as foundations and companies.

ASSOCIATIONS FOR CHILDREN AND YOUTH

Many children and young people are active in associations in their free time. There are a wide range of associations that are aimed at children and young people. For example, there are associations where you can be a scout, and associations where you can play theater. There are also sports associations where children can go to football, handball, horse riding, tennis, badminton, swimming, boxing, karate or gymnastics. The children often meet once or twice a week for training. Many associations also participate in tournaments where matches are arranged against other associations. Here, for example, the football teams in the neighboring municipalities play against each other. Such matches are usually played on a weekend.

It is common for parents to pay a membership fee* to the association for their child to be a member.

The fee must help cover the expenses that the association has for, for example, playing jerseys or equipment.

Many parents also actively participate in the clubs their children join. They can, for example, be coaches, helpers or pick up and drop off children at various events. The parents' support and encouragement is important for life in the club, because they depend on volunteer work.



Most sports clubs also have activities for adults. Here, all citizens can cultivate their interest in sports and physical education. You usually have to pay a membership fee. Sports associations are widespread throughout the country.

There are sports associations for large and popular sports such as football, handball, badminton and gymnastics. And there are associations for smaller sports such as dancing, horse riding and sailing. In each municipality there are overviews of which sports associations exist locally.

VOLUNTARY SOCIAL WORK

You can also volunteer in an association that does social, health or humanitarian work. These are associations that help other people who need support.

Examples of voluntary social work can be:

- Homework cafes where schoolchildren are helped with their homework
- Friendship families, where one family helps another family that needs support, e.g. in connection with the children's schooling or childcare, etc.
- Mentoring schemes, where a mentor gives good advice to, for example, a student, who need support and guidance to complete the training
- Shelters where you can help, so that, for example, homeless people can come and have a meal or a cup of coffee
- Visiting friend services, where lonely elderly people are visited by a volunteer visitor
- Various counseling activities, e.g. telephone lines such as BørneTelefonen, which children and young people with problems can call, and Livslinjen, which advises people with suicidal thoughts.

EVENING SCHOOLS

Many citizens in Denmark attend evening schools, where they can receive instruction in many different subjects. The starting point for the teaching is to provide general and professional insight and strengthen the individual's ability to take responsibility for their own lives and participate actively in society. There are therefore no exams at evening schools. You have to pay to attend evening school. You can, for example, receive instruction in languages, mathematics, geography or history. The teaching can also be about child-rearing or cultural subjects. There are also lessons in gymnastics, cooking, sewing, painting, singing and much more. Many evening schools also have special offers for people who come from other countries.

It is usually educational associations that are responsible for the various evening school offers. It could be, for example:

- AOF, Workers' Information Association
- LOF, Liberal Enlightenment Association
- FOF, Danish Association for Public Enlightenment
- DOF, Danish Education Association
- FORUM

COLLEGES

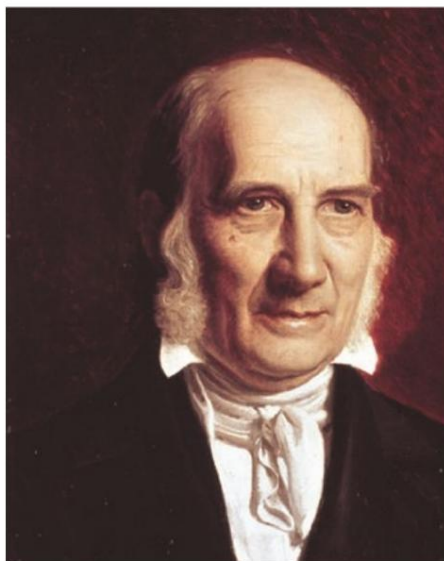
The college is part of the Danish tradition that all citizens should have the opportunity to learn and gain knowledge about society throughout their lives. There are around 70 different - like colleges in Denmark. At a college, the focus is on developing professionally and personally while also getting to know new people.

The colleges offer courses in, for example, philosophy, religion, art, literature, sports and politics. There are both short and long courses at the college. The short courses last about a week and are often held during the summer holidays. These can be courses where you talk about literature, art or music, or where you paint and draw. The long courses usually last between three and five months. There are also some – especially young people – who use a stay at college to find out

, which one to continue -

finish his or her education he or she wants choose. In addition to the lessons, there are also many other activities, such as excursions and trips. You usually live at the college during your stay. You have to pay for a stay at the college, but there are various options for getting financial support for your stay.

The college is inspired by Nikolai Frederik Severin Grundtvig (1783-1872), who was a Danish poet and priest. His ideas about school and learning had a great influence on, among other things, the development of colleges in Denmark. Grundtvig saw education for all as a way to create democracy in society.



NFS Grundtvig.

He believed it was important for children and adults to learn to think for themselves. They should not just learn what was in the books by heart. The teaching should make the students personally engaged in what they were reading. They should learn for their own sake and not just to get good grades. Therefore, you don't take exams at a college.



Rødding College.

LIBRARIES

There are public libraries in all municipalities.

They are an offer for all citizens. Here you can borrow books, magazines, music, films and computer games for free.

If you want to borrow something, you must either use your health card or a library card, which you can get at the library. Most materials are in Danish, but you can also borrow books and games in other languages. If your local library does not have the materials

If you need any materials, the library can usually order them from another library. In addition, the libraries have a

A number of online services are available free of charge to citizens. This includes, for example, 'eReolen' or 'Filmstriben', where citizens can borrow and stream* audiobooks, e-books, podcasts, films and TV series from home.

There is free access to computers and the internet, you can read the daily newspapers, and you can get help finding specific information or materials. The libraries also have many useful brochures from organizations and public authorities. authorities regarding, for example, health or new tax regulations.

Many libraries have homework cafes where volunteers, such as retired teachers or students, come and help children with their homework. The libraries organize exhibitions, show films and children's theater, and invite to lectures.



Frederiksberg Library.

Photo: Tue Petersen.

Fact sheet 9:

Health and illness

All citizens can go to the doctor or hospital if necessary.

The vast majority of treatments are free, and the costs are paid for through taxes. Some However, citizens must pay part of the costs of treatments themselves, such as visits to the dentist and physiotherapist. In addition, you usually have to pay part of the costs of your medication.

This fact sheet is about:

- Health card, general practitioner, medicine and pharmacies •
- Hospitals
- Dental care
- Child examinations and vaccinations
- Alcohol and cigarettes

HEALTH CARD, PRACTITIONER, MEDICINE AND PHARMACIES

When a citizen is registered in the Central Register of Persons (CPR) in a municipality, they receive a health card. The health card is a yellow plastic card, and can also be downloaded as an app on a mobile phone.



The card is proof that you have the right to treatment in the public healthcare system, and must be brought with you every time you are in contact with the healthcare system. This applies, for example, if you have to go to the doctor or the hospital.

Citizens are generally free to choose which GP they want, as long as the GP is open to new patients. When you get sick, the GP is usually the first person you go to. You do not have to pay to see your GP. The GP can treat many general health problems and can prescribe medication.

The doctor can also send the patient for examinations or treatment to, for example, a specialist, a physiotherapist or a hospital. It is said that the general practitioner refers the patient. However, you do not need a referral from your doctor if you need to go to the hospital urgently.

Medicine is usually bought at a pharmacy. Some medicines can only be bought if you have a prescription from your doctor. This is called prescription medicine. Other medicines can be bought without a prescription. This is called over-the-counter medicine.

You can buy all types of medicine at the pharmacy. Prescription medicine can only be bought at the pharmacy, while over-the-counter medicine for, for example, headaches and sore throats can also be bought in some supermarkets and the like.

The government provides subsidies* for most prescription medicines. The subsidy depends on, among other things, how much medicine you buy during the year. The subsidy is automatically deducted when you buy the medicine.

HOSPITALS

There are both public and private hospitals. The public hospitals are run by the Danish regions. Treatment at public hospitals is free of charge.

You may be admitted to hospital if you suddenly suffer an injury or illness and a doctor assesses that you need to be admitted. You may also be referred for examination or treatment at the hospital by your general practitioner. Some examinations and treatments at the hospital are outpatient, i.e. without you being admitted, but where you have to attend one of the country's many outpatient clinics.

Some hospitals also have an emergency department. You can go to the emergency department if you need urgent medical care that does not require an ambulance. This could be, for example, if you have broken an arm or sprained a foot. Treatment at the emergency department at public hospitals is free of charge. You must call the emergency room before arriving at the hospital.

In Denmark, you have free choice of hospital. This means that you can usually choose which public hospital you want to be treated at. If you choose a hospital However, outside the region where you live, you may be refused if there is no space.

You may also be referred to a private hospital if you have to wait more than a month for treatment at a public hospital. In that case, the treatment is at a private hospital for free. You can talk to your doctor about the possibility of choosing a hospital. When you are admitted to a hospital, you are often put in a room with two to three other patients. Women and men are not usually put in a room together.

The hospital ensures that patients are fed, showered, given clean clothes and are helped with what they need. Food is free for patients at public hospitals. The hospital also ensures that patients have, for example, bedding and towels, so you don't have to bring them from home. This is also free for patients at public hospitals.

It is important that the doctor and patient understand each other. If you need an interpreter when you go to the doctor or to the hospital, you have the right to have an interpreter called. In some cases, you have to pay a fee* to have an interpreter called.

It is also possible to visit family members or friends when they are admitted to a hospital. Most hospitals offer parents overnight stays when their child is admitted. are admitted. Parents of children admitted to the hospital are therefore welcome to be there outside visiting hours.

DENTAL CARE

All children and young people in Denmark can receive free dental care up to and including the age of 21 in the municipality in which they live. A significant part of the work of pediatric dentistry consists of teaching children how to take care of their teeth.



Adults aged 22 and over must find a private dentist themselves. You choose which dentist you want. Adults must pay for their own

examinations and treatment at the dentist. However, the government provides a subsidy, which is deducted from the bill.

CHILD EXAMINATIONS AND VACCINATIONS

Parents with a newborn child will be visited by a health nurse at home immediately after the birth. The health nurse can give advice and guidance to the parents about the child. It is free to be visited by a health nurse.

From the age of five weeks to the age of five years, a child can also have seven preventive child examinations at the doctor. The examinations are carried out according to a specific program. The purpose is to monitor how the child is developing and thriving.

Children can also be vaccinated against a number of childhood diseases. The vaccinations are free and are given by the general practitioner. Children can be vaccinated against the diseases diphtheria, tetanus, whooping cough, polio, the Hib bacteria, pneumococcal disease, measles, mumps, rubella and HPV. If you need special vaccinations in connection with a trip abroad, you must pay for them yourself.



ALCOHOL AND CIGARETTES

In Denmark, a number of laws have been passed to make people healthier and prevent* so-called lifestyle diseases. Lifestyle diseases are diseases that are related to the way you live, for example smoking, drinking or eating too much fatty food.

The Danish Parliament has decided, among other things, that you must be at least 16 years old to buy beer, and that you must be 18 years old to buy alcohol over six percent, that is, very strong beer, wine and spirits. But you must also be 18 years old to buy cigarettes. And it has been agreed that from 2025, 16- and 17-year-olds will no longer be able to buy alcohol over six percent, so that you must also be at least 18 years old to buy wine and very strong beer. In nightlife zones, you must also be 18 years old to buy alcohol after 10 p.m.

Stores may require identification to verify whether a person is old enough to purchase alcohol and cigarettes.

A smoking law has also been passed, which means that it is prohibited to smoke indoors in public* places: For example, in buses, sports halls and cinemas. It is prohibited to smoke in workplaces and schools and the vast majority of restaurants, cafés, bars and discos.

Students at schools, boarding schools, after-school programs and youth education (e.g. high schools and vocational schools) are prohibited from smoking and using tobacco products, tobacco substitutes, herbal smoking products or electronic cigarettes with or without nicotine during school hours (including outside the school premises). In addition, tobacco products, tobacco substitutes, herbal smoking products and electronic cigarettes and refill containers with or without nicotine must generally be hidden in stores so that they cannot be seen by customers. Products that are intended to be used with these products are also covered by the ban.



Fact sheet 10:

Equality

Equal treatment and equality mean that all citizens, regardless of gender, ethnic origin or religion, must be treated equally. If you are treated differently without any objective reason for it, in some situations this will be illegal discrimination, for example if you are not selected for a certain job because of your gender or religion. You can be punished for discriminating.

This fact sheet is about the rules for equal treatment within:

- Labor market and education
- Political life
- Private life

LABOR MARKET AND EDUCATION

In the Danish labor market, there is a prohibition against discrimination. In the Danish labor market, discrimination is not allowed on the basis of:

- Gender
- Race
- Skin color
- Religion or belief
- Political opinion*
- Sexual orientation
- Age
- Handicap
- National, social or ethnic background*

An employer may therefore not, as a general rule, refuse to employ people on the basis of, for example, gender, disability or ethnic background. In special cases, the employer may impose requirements* regarding clothing, for example that certain clothing be worn for reasons of hygiene and safety in the workplace.

The rules for equal treatment also apply when you have been hired at a workplace. For example, an employer may not fire a person because of the person's ethnic background* or pay a person less because of their gender. An employer may also not fail to promote* a person because of, for example, the person's gender, disability or age.

According to the Equal Pay Act, men and women are entitled to the same pay for the same work.

Equality also applies in the field of education. Everyone has equal access to the education system. If you want to take a specific course of study, you have the right to apply for admission to the relevant* course of study, regardless of your background.

And the same applies if a person wishes to obtain an internship in connection with their vocational training. A workplace may not refuse to provide

an internship because of their gender, religion or ethnic origin.

Outside the labor market, there are also rules that prohibit discrimination based on, for example, gender, race, or ethnicity.

If you experience discrimination based on, for example, gender or ethnic origin in violation of the law, you can complain to the Equal Treatment Board. Complaining is free.

POLITICAL LIFE



The Parliament. Photo: Prime Minister's Office.

It is a central principle of Danish democracy that citizens must not be prevented from voting or standing for election because of, for example, their gender, ethnic background, sexual orientation or religion.

Denmark got its first free constitution in 1849, when the Constitution of the Kingdom of Denmark was signed. But that did not mean that everyone got the right to vote. For example, women were not allowed to vote. more.

Women's right to vote in the legislative assembly was introduced in 1915, when the constitution was amended.

Today, it is common to have female ministers and mayors, and 44 percent of the members of the Danish Parliament are women.

Women and men thus have the same political rights and can vote and stand for election in the general assembly and local elections on the same terms.* Women and men also have the same right to participate in public debate and to be members of political parties.

The first female minister in Denmark was Nina Bang, who became Minister of Education in 1924, and in 2011 Denmark got its first female Prime Minister, Helle Thorning-Schmidt.

PRIVATE AND FAMILY LIFE

Equality also applies in private and family life. Men and women are of equal value and should have equal opportunities to live the life they want and the same right to make decisions about their own lives.

Regardless of whether you are a man or a woman, in Denmark you have the right to decide for yourself who you want to marry. Marriage is an equal partnership, and men and women therefore have equal rights in a marriage. Both men and women make decisions about themselves, even if they are married. This means, for example, that everyone can decide for themselves what they do during the day, what clothes they wear, and who they meet. However, you also have obligations to each other in a marriage. For example, both spouses have a duty to support each other and their children.

Both women and men have the right to divorce – regardless of whether the spouse also wants to divorce or not. If a couple with children divorce, it is usually the case that the parents retain joint custody*.

Joint custody means that the parents must together provide for the child and agree on important decisions about the child, such as the child's name, religion and school.

Everyone over the age of 18 also has the right to decide on their own money, and the salary you earn is your own money, regardless of whether you are a woman or a man.

In Denmark, girls and boys have the same rights and should have the same opportunities in life. This means that girls and boys have the right to the same freedom, responsibility, care, duties and opportunities. Both girls and boys should have equal opportunities to live the life they want, and therefore have the same right to choose what education they want, what they want to do for a living, and who they want to marry.

Same-sex couples have the right to marry, and they have the right to adopt children on the same terms as couples of different sexes.



The rainbow flag is a symbol for LBGT+ people.

Fact sheet 11:

Democracy and the Constitution

Denmark is a democracy. This is evident, for example, through rules for elections, democratic rights and a democratic culture.

When there are elections, it is the citizens who elect the politicians to the Folketing, municipal councils, regional councils and the European Parliament, and the elections are free and secret*.

Citizens also have rights that give them the freedom to do whatever they want, as long as they obey the laws. Authorities, such as the police or the municipality, are generally not allowed to interfere in what citizens do. Citizens, for example, have the freedom to form associations and to have the religion they want.

There are also many associations in Denmark that function as a kind of mini-democracy, where the members elect the leadership – and remove it – if a disagreement arises between members and management. In this way, democracy also helps to shape* society and culture more generally.

The Constitution of the Kingdom of Denmark is the constitution of Denmark*. In everyday life, it is often called the Basic Law. The Constitution contains the most important rules about Denmark's form of government, and the Constitution guarantees citizens a number of fundamental rights. Other laws in Denmark may not conflict with the Constitution.

This fact sheet is about:

- The Constitution
- The Danish monarchy
- The separation of powers

THE CONSTITUTION – THE CONSTITUTION OF DENMARK

Denmark got its first democratic constitution, the Constitution, in 1849. Since 1849

The Constitution has only been amended a few times. The last time was in 1953. The Constitution is the supreme law of the country. It is more difficult to amend the Constitution than other laws. If the Constitution is to be amended, it is not enough for a majority in the Folketing to want to amend it.



The Constitution.

An amendment to the Constitution must first be adopted by the current Parliament. After that, new elections must be held for the Parliament, and then the new Parliament must adopt* the bill in its unchanged form. Then there must be a referendum on the proposal. The proposal can only be adopted if a majority of those participating in the referendum, and at least 40 percent of all voters, vote in favor of it.

Since the constitution was adopted in 1849, democracy has been strengthened in several ways. strengthened. For example, women gained the right to vote in the Folketing with the amendment to the constitution in 1915. The voting age has also been lowered several times. In 1849, men were required to You had to be 30 years old to vote for the Folketing, while you only had to be 25 years old to be elected. Today you have to be 18 years old to vote and be elected. The Constitution gives citizens a number of freedoms, which means that citizens can say and do certain things without first getting permission from the authorities.



Debate between the party leaders, 2021.

Photo: Mads Claus Rasmussen/Ritzau Scanpix.

Freedom of expression covers the right to publicly say and write what one thinks.

But there is a limitation on freedom of expression, because the expressions* must not be illegal. This means that the legislation can set limits on which expressions should be punishable. For example, defamation* is punishable. Expressions that are in conflict* with the racism section* can also be.

However, the authorities do not have to approve first, what you say and write before you publish it. But if it turns out that be illegal, you may be punished afterwards.

Freedom of assembly ensures the right to meet for public meetings and demonstrations, for example. An assembly does not have to be approved by the police before it can be held, but you must notify the police first if you want to hold a public assembly. If you do not notify the police first, you can still hold the assembly, but you may be fined for not notifying the police at least 24 hours in advance.

Freedom of association ensures the right to form associations with lawful purposes. These can be, for example, associations with sporting, political, cultural or social purposes.

Permission from the authorities is not required to establish an association.

Freedom of association is an essential part of democracy in Danish society.

However, freedom of association is limited. The Constitution states that associations that have a violent* purpose can be dissolved. It is the courts that decide whether an association should be dissolved because the association has a violent purpose.

The Constitution also protects the inviolability of the home. This means, among other things, that the police are generally not allowed to enter people's homes without the approval of a judge.

The Constitution also protects personal freedom. Personal freedom means, among other things, that an arrested person must be brought before a judge within 24 hours. The judge must then decide* whether the arrested person should be released or whether the person in question should continue to be deprived of his or her liberty*.

The Constitution also guarantees freedom of religion. Freedom of religion means that one can choose one's own religion and that one has the right to practice one's religion as long as one respects certain basic rules. However, the Constitution also states that the Danish National Church has a special position* and that it is supported* by the state.

However, this does not mean that the state may not support other religions if it wishes, for example by making land available* for a church, temple or mosque.



The Constituent Assembly.

THE DANISH MONARCHY

Denmark is a monarchy. This means that the Danish head of state is a monarch, i.e. a king or a queen.

King Frederik X is not elected by the people, but has inherited the throne. He inherited the throne in 2024 from his mother, Queen Margrethe II, who had inherited it from her father, King Frederik IX. After Frederik X, the throne will be inherited by Crown Prince Christian. When the monarch dies, the eldest child inherits the throne.

King Frederik X has no political power. He has some official functions when a new government is to be formed, and he signs the country's laws together with the ministers. But it is not the king who decides who will form the government, who will be ministers, or what will be in the laws. And the king does not speak publicly about politics.

The King often travels around and visits different parts of Denmark. He also travels on state visits to other countries. This means that he visits the kings, queens or presidents of other countries. In this way, the King represents Denmark abroad and helps to raise awareness about Denmark. Politicians, business people and civil servants also go on state visits to, among other things, make trade agreements. This can, for example, help to increase* Danish exports.

King Frederik X has been married to Queen Mary, who is originally from Australia, since 2004. Together they have four children (Crown Prince Christian, Princess Isabella and the twins Prince Vincent and Princess Josephine).

There is great support* for the monarchy in Denmark. When the king travels around the country, there are always many spectators. And every year on New Year's Eve, December 31, the king gives a New Year's speech, which is shown on television. It is watched by many citizens of Denmark.

Denmark's first free constitution was signed in 1849. Before that, there had been almost 200 years of absolute monarchy since 1660-61. Absolute monarchy was a form of government in which the king had sole power. Denmark's last absolute monarch was Frederik VII. He became king in 1848 and relinquished his absolute power the same year. The current constitution dates from 1953.



King Frederik X with Queen Mary, Crown Prince Christian, Princess Isabella, Prince Vincent, and Princess Josephine (from left)

THE DIVISION OF STATE POWER IN THREES

The state power in Denmark is divided into three branches: legislative, executive and judicial. This means that the state power is not concentrated in one place.

The legislative power is vested in the government and the Danish Parliament jointly*. Most legislative proposals are proposed* by The government, and it is the Folketing that adopts them. The bill must then be signed by the King and a minister. Once the bill has been signed, it becomes law and must be published.

The executive power is with the government. This means that the ministers, together with the civil servants in ministries and other public authorities ensure that the laws are implemented* and complied with.

The judicial power is with the courts, which decide* legal cases. The courts are independent*. This means that the judges must only obey the laws. Politicians cannot

determine how courts should decide specific legal cases.

The idea behind this separation of powers is, among other things, that the Folketing can control the government, and that the courts can assess whether a decision made by a public authority is legal or not. In addition, the courts can assess whether a law is compatible with the Constitution.



The Parliament Hall.



The court in Frederiksberg.

Fact sheet 12:

The Danish legal community

As a citizen, you have a duty to obey the laws of the country, and some laws can be punished for breaking them. The police investigate cases where there is suspicion that a person has done something criminal*. But it is the courts that decide whether a person should be punished for breaking the law.

This fact sheet is about:

- The police
- Courts and punishment

POLICE

Among other things, the police's task is to ensure peace and order and to prevent, investigate* and solve crime. If there is suspicion* that a person has committed a criminal offence, the police investigate the case. The police question* the person and collect evidence. It is also the police that you contact if you yourself are the victim* of a crime. You can call, send a letter or an e-mail or go to a police station.



The police must follow a number of rules when they arrest or question a person.

These rules are there to protect the citizen. For example, the police may not use violence or threaten violence during questioning. The police must also inform the arrested person of what he or she is suspected of.



If a person is arrested because he or she is suspected of having

committed a criminal offence, the person must either be released again or brought before a judge within 24 hours.

The judge must then decide whether the person should be released or should be imprisoned while the police investigate the case.



COURTS AND PUNISHMENT

It is the courts that assess whether a person accused of a criminal offence is guilty and should be punished. Some cases do not have to go to court if the suspects themselves agree to be punished with a fine. This is seen, among other things, in for violations of traffic laws*. Children under 15 years of age cannot be punished and therefore cannot be sentenced to pay fines or go to prison. However, the authorities can decide that the young person must be placed outside the home, or order* the young person to participate in certain activities.

The courts are independent*. This means that the government or the Folketing cannot decide how the courts should rule in a particular case. The judges must only comply with what is stated in the laws that the Folketing has passed.

The government or Parliament cannot dismiss a judge if they are dissatisfied with how he or she judges in criminal cases.

Most cases are decided in the district court. There are 24 district courts spread across the country, and the Maritime and Commercial Court in Copenhagen. In the Faroe Islands there is one court (the Faroe Islands Court). In Greenland there is one high court (the Greenland High Court), one court (the Court in Greenland) and a number of district courts. When a judgment has been given in the district court, you can normally appeal* the judgment to the high court if you disagree with the district court's judgment. This means that you ask to have the decision* reviewed by the high court. There are two high courts in Denmark: the Eastern High Court in Copenhagen and the Western High Court in Viborg.

As mentioned, there is also a High Court in Greenland. When a case has been appealed to the High Court, and the High Court has made a decision, the case cannot usually be appealed to Denmark's highest court, the Supreme Court. If a case has started with proceedings in the High Court, it can usually be appealed to the Supreme Court.

There is usually public access to the courtroom when a case is being heard. However, certain cases are heard behind closed doors. The judge may also decide that a person may not be allowed into the courtroom, for example if the person is drunk*. The judge may also refuse a person entry into the courtroom if it is necessary to obtain a truthful statement from a witness.



PENALTY

The usual penalties in Denmark are a fine or imprisonment. The harshest penalty is life imprisonment. There is no death penalty in Denmark. A sentence can be unconditional or conditional. An unconditional prison sentence means that the prison sentence must be served. A suspended prison sentence means that you can avoid serving the prison sentence if you meet certain conditions* for a period of time. These conditions are determined by the courts. One of the conditions is that the convicted person does not commit any new crimes for a period of time, for example one or two years. Another condition may be that the convicted person must perform community service without receiving any pay for it.

Conditional imprisonment is often used for people who have not previously been convicted, and for less serious crimes.



Storstrøm Prison on Falster.

Photo: Danish Prison and Probation Service.

Criminal record

A criminal record is a document that shows whether a person has been punished for certain crimes. If you have been convicted, the criminal record will tell you what you have been punished for, and what punishment you have received. The criminal record that you yourself can be issued and shown to a private employer, is called a private criminal record certificate.

Violation of the Criminal Code, the legislation on euphoric substances*, the legislation on explosives*, violation of a restraining order issued under the Act on restraining orders*, residence bans and expulsions (i.e. if you violate a restraining order, residence ban or expulsion) as well as certain traffic violations are included in the private criminal record. If you are punished abroad, it can also be noted on the criminal record. Information on the Private criminal records are deleted again after two to five years depending* on the punishment. is in question.

Employers sometimes ask to see a criminal record before hiring someone. person. In some cases, the employer may refuse to employ people who have been punished or who do not want to show their criminal record. You can contact the police to obtain his criminal record.

Fact sheet 13:

Parliament and government

Denmark's parliament is called the Folketinget. The Folketing works at Christiansborg Palace in Copenhagen and, together with the government, forms the legislative branch.

This fact sheet is about:

- Parliament
- Government
- Representative democracy

THE PARLIAMENT

The Folketing is the parliament of Denmark.

The Folketing has 179 members. Two are elected in the Faroe Islands and two in Greenland, while the remaining 175 are elected in Denmark. The members of the Folketing

The member of parliament is almost always a member of a political party.

The Folketing works at Christiansborg Palace in Copenhagen and, together with the government, constitutes the legislative power.

In the Folketing, the proposals that become the country's laws are discussed and adopted.

The Folketing also has other tasks than legislation.

It is the Folketing that decides who will form the government after an election. In addition, it is an important task for the Folketing to control the government. Members of the Folketing can, for example, demand that a minister answer questions about a specific matter.



The Parliament Hall.

Danish democracy is a parliamentary democracy. This means that the Folketing decides who will have the power of government, as a government cannot be appointed* if it has a majority in the Folketing against it. And if a sitting government gets a majority in the Folketing against it in a matter that it itself attributes* great importance to importance (such as the Finance Act), it may happen that the government resigns or chooses to print selection.

Denmark does not, like some other countries, have a so-called upper house that must approve the decisions of the Folketing.

Political work in the Folketing

Members of the Folketing discuss policy and new bills, and they pass bills at meetings of the Folketing.

The meetings are usually public. This means that

As an ordinary citizen, you can normally sit in the audience seats and watch the politicians' discussions in the Folketing. You can also watch TV from the Folketing.

on the Folketing's website and on television on the special Folketing channel. On the Folketing's website you can see which laws and political topics are being discussed in the Folketing on a particular day.

An important part of the Folketing's work is to discuss and adopt legislative proposals. Every Wednesday there is question time in the Folketing. Here, one or more ministers answer questions from members of the Folketing, and the questioner and the minister discuss the answer. In this way, the members of the Folketing can check that the ministers are implementing the laws in the right way, or have a more general political discussion with the ministers.



Members of Parliament can ask written questions to ministers, which they then answer either orally in the House of Representatives or in writing directly to the questioner. The minister's written answers are generally publicly available*.

Prime minister Mette Frederiksen on Parliament lectern. Photo: The Prime Minister's Office.

The political work in the parliamentary committees

The members of the Folketing not only meet in the parliament chamber. They are also members of the Folketing's standing committees, which roughly correspond to the various ministries. For example, there are committees that work on employment, defense, and food.

The committees consider the proposed bills, and the committees often ask a wide range of questions to the minister in question. All bills must be read three times in the Folketing before they can be adopted, and the bills are discussed and worked through in the committees between the three readings in the Folketing.

Citizens or associations can also request to meet with a parliamentary committee.

You can write, email or call the committee to explain* your case and possibly request a meeting with the committee, which can then ask clarifying questions.

The committee works on general legislation within the committee's area of expertise.

For example, the Legal Affairs Committee works with, among other things, the police, courts and punishment, and the Europe Committee works with Denmark's relationship with the EU. The number of committees may vary.

Citizens are free to write to members of the Folketing if, for example, they want to draw attention to a problem in society. All members of the Folketing receive many such inquiries from citizens.



Christiansborg Palace in Copenhagen with the Folketing.
many ministries. Photo: Tue Redersen

Around Schou lies Supreme Court and

THE GOVERNMENT

As mentioned, the government forms part of the legislative power. The government also has executive power. This means that it is the government, together with the other public authorities, that implements and administers the legislation that has been adopted in the Folketing. This is done through the ministries. But the government does not only take care of administrative tasks. The government forms the political leadership of the country, and it is, for example, the government that comes up with the vast majority of bill.

When a bill is passed by the Folketing and signed by the King and the relevant minister, it is the ministers, together with the officials in the ministries and other public authorities, who must ensure that the law is implemented.

implemented. But it is the individual ministers who are responsible for what goes on in their ministry.

The Prime Minister leads the government, which usually consists of about 20 ministers. As a rule, the ministers are members of the Folketing, but they do not have to be. It is the Prime Minister alone who decides who will be a minister and how many ministers there will be in a government. Normally, each minister has a ministry that he or she heads and has ultimate responsibility for. There are, for example, ministries for tax, culture, defence and education and health. However, one person can be a minister for more than one ministry.

Ministries can also be merged, new ministries can be established, or tasks can be moved from one ministry to another. This is decided by the Prime Minister. This usually happens after a general election, when a new government has been formed. But it can also happen during an election period.

The governing parties are the political parties that have ministers in the government. Sometimes the government power lies with one party, but usually several parties have government power together.

When several parties together hold government power, it is called a coalition government.

If the governing parties together have a majority in the Folketing, we speak of a majority government. If the governing parties do not have a majority in the Folketing, the government is called a minority government. A minority government depends* on support from other parties in the Folketing if it is to have its bills passed. The parties outside the government that support a minority government are often called supporting parties.

The vast majority of governments since the end of World War II in 1945 have been minority governments. Therefore, there is a tradition in Denmark of cooperation across parties, i.e. the government negotiates* with the other parties in the Folketing to gain support for the adoption of its legislative proposals. In many areas, it is common for a government to make agreements with one or more of the parties that are not the government's supporting parties. However, since 2022, Denmark has had a majority government consisting of the Social Democrats, the Liberals and the Moderates.

Representative democracy

Denmark is a representative democracy. This means that the people elect the politicians they most agree with to the Folketing. It is therefore the politicians who, as the people's representatives, take care of the legislation. It is rare for a bill to be put to a referendum. In fact, there have only been 16 referendums since the current constitution was adopted in 1953. More than half (nine out of 16) have been about Denmark's relationship with the EU.

Fact sheet 14:

Local self- government

There is a long tradition of local self-government in Denmark. It is the municipal and regional councils that are responsible for local self-government. The idea behind local self-government is that the public tasks that affect the daily lives of citizens to do must be solved as close to the citizens as possible.

When a citizen needs to contact the public sector, he or she often turns to the municipality's citizen service. Here you can get answers to questions if, for example, you are moving or have a pension. And you can usually get practical things sorted out, for example, if you need a passport or driver's license.

Municipalities and regions are governed by elected assemblies. In municipalities, they are called municipal councils, and in regions, they are called regional councils. Elections for municipalities and regional councils are held at the same time. They take place every four years (2017, 2021, 2025, etc.).

This fact sheet is about:

- Local self-government
- Municipalities
- The regions

MUNICIPALITIES

There are 98 municipalities in Denmark. They have very different sizes. This applies both in terms of population and area.

The municipalities are responsible for the most of the welfare benefits* that citizens have the opportunity to obtain, and are responsible for the operation of, for example, public kindergartens, nurseries and primary schools. For example, you register your child in kindergarten, nursery school and primary school at the municipality. The municipalities have also important tasks in connection with, for example, employment, integration, roads, waste collection, the environment and leisure and cultural offerings.



Copenhagen City Hall.

In addition, the municipalities are responsible for a number of social services and offers, such as help for older citizens who have difficulty managing themselves, as well as help for people with disabilities or certain forms of mental illness. The municipality's citizen service can tell you where to turn for various questions.



Municipalities in Denmark.

Elected municipal councils lead the country's municipalities.

The chairman of the municipal council is called the mayor (in Copenhagen: the chief mayor). The mayor is the chief executive of the municipality's administration.

The mayor is elected by the newly elected municipal council.



The municipal council itself decides, within certain limits, how many members there should be on the municipal council. There are between 19 and 31 members on the municipal council, depending on what the municipal council has decided. In the smallest municipalities, however, there are down to nine members and in Copenhagen up to 55 members. This must be an odd number of members on the municipal council.

Every year, the government makes an agreement with the municipalities' interest group KL (Kommunernes Landsforening) on how much money the municipalities together are allowed to spend. This allows the government to influence the overall municipal economy.

The municipalities then agree among themselves how the amount will be distributed to the individual municipalities.

The individual municipal council then decides how much money to spend on the welfare services for which the municipal council is responsible. For example, the municipal council can decide how many nurseries, kindergartens and primary schools there should be in the municipality.

The municipalities have the right to levy* taxes. In this way, they themselves help to raise part of the money to solve their tasks. The state also gives money to the municipalities according to some special rules. The 98 municipalities have an interest organization called the National Association of Municipalities (KL).

THE REGIONS

Denmark is divided into five regions. They are:

- Capital Region (Copenhagen and surrounding area, North Zealand and Bornholm)
- Region Zealand (West Zealand, Central Zealand, South Zealand and Lolland-Falster)
- Region of Southern Denmark (Funen and South and Southern Jutland)
- Central Denmark Region (East, Central and West Denmark)
- North Jutland Region (North Jutland)

The Capital Region and Region Zealand will merge on January 1, 2027.

The new, merged region will be called Region Eastern Denmark.

The regions have responsibility for the health sector, among other things.

It is the regions that run* the public hospitals.

The regions do not have the right to levy taxes, but receive their money directly from the state. Each region is governed by a regional council headed by a regional council chairman.

Regional council elections are held every four years. Many of the parties that run for regional council elections also run for the Folketing. The regional council chairman is elected by the regional council.

The regional councils each have 41 members. The five regions have an interest organization called Danish Regions.



Patient being attended to by a doctor and nurse at the regional hospital in Køge. and Photo: Tor Birk Trads/RitzauScanpix.

Fact sheet 15:

Democracy in practice – elections and parties

Free elections are one of the most important things in a democracy. By voting in parliamentary elections, each citizen has influence* on who will be a member of the Folketing. In municipal and regional elections, you have influence on who will be a member of the local municipal council or the local regional council.

This fact sheet is about:

- Elections and parties
- Political activity

ELECTIONS AND PARTIES

Free and secret elections are one of the most important things in a democracy. There are four elections held in Denmark for political bodies.

This corresponds to four political levels:

1. The local level: Municipal-
the board of directors
2. The regional level: the Regional Council
3. The national level: The Danish Parliament
4. The EU level: The European Parliament



In addition, referendums are sometimes held on very specific issues, such as the voting age or whether Denmark should cede sovereignty, i.e. Danish self-determination, to an international body. The most important example of cede sovereignty is Denmark's membership of the EU.

You are not obliged to vote in elections, but many do. The voting percentage is high in Denmark compared to many other countries. Normally, between 80 and 90 percent of those eligible to vote vote in parliamentary elections. Fewer people vote in municipal and regional elections (in 2021 67 percent) and in elections to the European Parliament (in 2024 58 percent).

ELECTIONS TO THE FOLKETING

The Prime Minister decides when parliamentary elections are to be called, but there must be elections to the Folketing at least every four years. And this often happens before the four years have passed. To be able to vote in parliamentary elections, you must have the right to vote, i.e. you must:

- Have Danish citizenship
- Be over 18 years of age
- Have permanent residence in Denmark, the Faroe Islands or Greenland

If you meet the conditions* for having the right to vote, you are normally also eligible, i.e. you can be elected to the Danish Parliament.

In Denmark, 175 members are elected to the Folketing. The populations of Greenland and the Faroe Islands also elect two members each to the Folketing. This means that there are a total of 179 members of the Folketing. After the last Folketing,

In the parliamentary elections, 43 percent of the elected members of the Folketing are women.

MUNICIPAL AND REGIONAL ELECTIONS

There are elections for local and regional councils every four years. You must be 18 years of age to vote in local and regional elections. You vote for the politicians in the municipality and region where you live.

You do not need Danish citizenship to vote in municipal and regional elections. People who are citizens of another EU country, Norway or Iceland also have the right to vote in municipal and regional elections if they have permanent residence in Denmark. In addition, other foreigners who have lived permanently in Denmark for the last four years before election day have the right to vote in municipal and regional elections. If you

If you meet the conditions for having the right to vote, you are generally also eligible to be elected, i.e. you can be elected to the municipal council or regional council.

There are a total of 98 municipalities in Denmark. A municipal council is elected in each municipality. The individual municipal councils have a different number of members – between 19 and 31, depending on what the municipal council has decided.

In the smallest municipalities, however, there are down to nine members and in Copenhagen there are up to 55 members. Around 36 percent of those elected are women. In the municipalities, local parties are often also set up* that do not run for the Folketing, but only run in a specific municipality.

Elections for the regional council take place at the same time as the elections for the municipal council.

There are five regions in Denmark, and each region has a regional council. There are 41 members in each regional council. Around 50 percent of those elected are women.

The regional councils primarily take care of the hospitals.

EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT ELECTIONS

There are elections to the European Parliament every five years (2019, 2024, 2029, etc.).

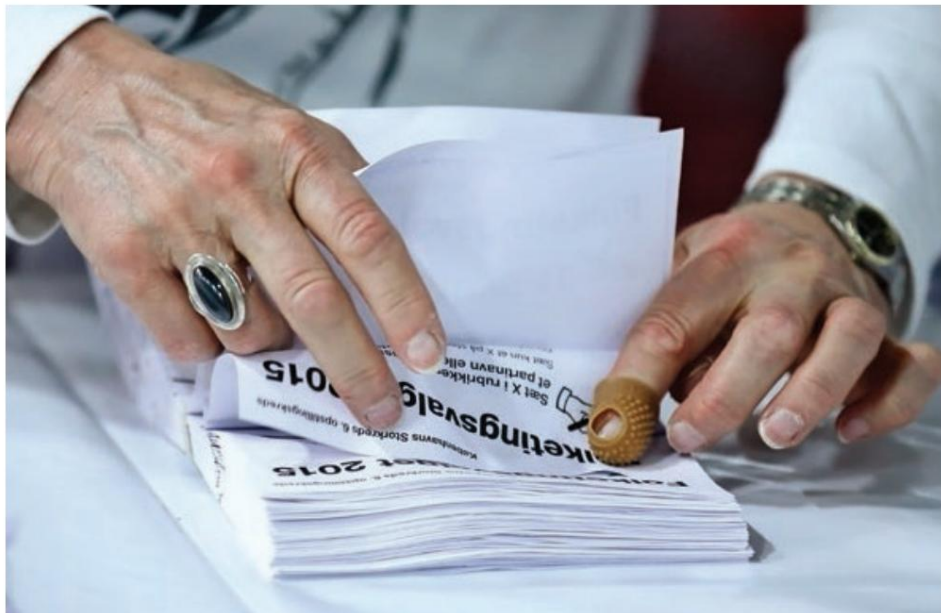
The elections take place within the same period in all EU countries. You have the right to vote in the European Parliament elections in Denmark if you are a citizen of an EU country and have reached the age of 18. As an EU citizen, you can vote in the EU country where you live or in the EU country of which you are a citizen. Denmark elects 15 members to the European Parliament.

HOW AN ELECTION IS MADE

An election is held by secret ballot. This means that no one else is allowed to see what or who you are voting for. A few days before the election, you will receive a voting card in the mail. The voting card is proof that you have the right to vote. The voting card contains information about where and when you should vote. The polling place can be, for example, a local school or a town hall. If you have the right to vote and have not received a voting card, you can contact the municipality. However, you can still vote if you do not have your voting card with you. In that case, you must bring identification.

On election day, you take your voter card with you to the polling station. When you get to the polling station, you hand in your voter card and receive a ballot with the names of all those who are running in the election and who you can vote for in your municipality and region. The names are arranged according to which party the candidates belong to. You vote by putting a cross either next to a party or next to a specific person (a candidate) on the ballot paper. Some people also choose to vote blank, often as a protest. This means that you do not put a cross, but simply hand in his ballot.

You can also vote before the election if you prefer, for example because you are away on election day. This is called postal voting. You can vote by post anywhere in the country, not just in the municipality where you live – as well as at all Danish representations abroad.



THE POLITICAL PARTIES

A political party is an association that works for a specific political program and nominates candidates for an election.

It usually consists of people who support a particular political program, i.e. a set of views on society. Anyone can join a political party.

In an election campaign, the political struggle takes place primarily between the parties' candidates. However, in parliamentary elections, one can also stand as a candidate outside the parties.

In the vast majority of cases, members of the Folketing are members of a political party. However, it has happened that a person has been elected to the Folketing without being a member of a political party.

In the 2022 general election, the following parties were represented in the Folketing.

The parties are listed according to how many votes they received:

- Social Democrats
- Left
- The Moderates
- Socialist People's Party
- The Danish Democrats
- Liberal Alliance
- The Conservative People's Party
- The Unity List
- Radical Left
- New Civil
- The alternative
- Danish People's Party

As well as two members elected in the Faroe Islands from each party:

- The Social Democratic Party
- The Union Party

And two members elected in Greenland from each party:

- Inuit Ataqatigiit
- Siumut

Sometimes a politician in the Danish Parliament disagrees with his or her party and chooses to resign from the party. However, this does not mean that the politician must leave the Danish Parliament. If the politician wants to continue as a member of the Danish Parliament, he or she can either switch to another party or become an independent, i.e. stand outside the parties. The person can also choose to start a completely new party.

POLITICAL ACTIVITY

Political parties

A political party typically consists of people who largely* share political views.

Freedom of association means that no authority can interfere with whether you join a party or which party you are a member of. Approximately 110,000 are members of a political party.

Members usually pay a dues* to the party, but the parties also receive money from the state in proportion to how many votes the party receives. Political parties are associations with a democratic structure. Today, they are organized as local (e.g. municipal) voter associations, and one of the most important tasks of party members is to decide who should be candidates for the different types of elections. Political parties have different rules for how candidates are selected.



Interest groups

Many citizens are members of an interest organization. This is an association* of people who have a common interest, for example a union for cleaning staff or a patient association for people with heart problems.

Companies can also form interest groups, such as farmers' or shopkeepers' organizations. There can also be organizations that focus on a specific issue, such as Amnesty International or the Danish Nature Conservation Association. An interest group tries to influence the policy that

are conducted in areas that are important to the organization's members. The large interest organizations thus often have contact with politicians and civil servants and try to influence the politicians - for example by providing them with various forms of knowledge about topics that are important to the interest organization.

Grassroots movements and demonstrations

Grassroots movements are less formally organized than interest organizations. In a grassroots movement, it is primarily the activity of the participants that gives the movement its power.

Many grassroots movements use protests to influence politicians.

This can sometimes be through demonstrations, but the most common is collecting signatures.

In Denmark, there is freedom to demonstrate. Before holding processions and meetings on the roads, you must notify the police, but no permission is required to hold the demonstration. The police can sometimes require that a demonstration be held elsewhere.

This could be, for example, if the police believe that there is a risk that the demonstration will turn violent. The police can also set requirements for how the demonstration should take place. It is only under very special circumstances that the police can prohibit a demonstration.

Use of media

As a citizen, you can try to influence politics by writing a letter to the editor in a newspaper. You can also contact newspapers or TV directly to draw attention to an issue and then hope that the media will take up the matter.

Electronic media provide other opportunities to influence politics. Through petitions via the Internet or in Facebook groups, the population can debate politicians, parties or various specific issues. Citizens can also show their dissatisfaction with certain laws or regulations and in this way influence politicians. Citizens also make extensive use of the opportunity to

write comments on newspaper websites or posts on various discussion forums on the Internet.

The politicians addresses also increasingly communicate with the population through social media, Facebook and X. For example, it sometimes happens that politicians comment on a case on Facebook instead of

show up for an interview.



Fact sheet 16:

Citizens' rights and duties

Danish society is a democracy and a welfare society. This means that citizens have a number of rights. Firstly, citizens have democratic rights, which include political rights and freedoms.

Secondly, citizens in the welfare society have some social rights, which include the right to a number of social services and benefits. Conversely, citizens also have some duties. These include tax obligations and military service*.

This fact sheet is about:

- Rights
- Duties

RIGHTS

Political rights

Political rights include the right to vote in elections and to stand* as a candidate for, among other things, the Danish Parliament or municipal councils.

Freedom rights

These rights include:

- Freedom of religion, i.e. the right to choose one's own religion
- Freedom of expression, i.e. the right to say and write what one believes without first having received permission from the authorities
- Freedom of assembly, i.e. the right to meet (also in public), e.g. to demonstrate without first having received permission from the authorities
- Freedom of association, i.e. the right to form associations with lawful purposes without having first obtained permission from the authorities



Social rights

Social rights include the right to receive various types of benefits* and offers if you need help. This could be, for example, free medical care if you are sick, or financial support if you cannot support yourself.

DUTIES

Tax liability

You are obliged to pay tax on your income. You must not only pay tax on your salary, but also on many social benefits and SU – the state's education subsidy.

You also have to pay tax on, for example, income from interest in the bank and on gains from selling shares*. In some cases, you have to pay tax on gifts that you receive, for example, from your family. This depends, among other things, on the value of the gift and who you received it from.

Military service

All men and women in Denmark over the age of 18 with Danish citizenship are obliged to help defend the country. This is called military service. Therefore, everyone living in Denmark is automatically called up for the so-called "Defense Day".

Until July 1, 2025, only men were subject to military service, and women could decide for themselves whether they wanted to serve in the military if they were declared suitable* for it. On "Armed Forces Day", young women and men must undergo various tests and a health examination. It is then assessed whether the young people are suitable for military service. Normally, about half of the young people are declared suitable.

Then everyone draws a lottery number, which must be used if there are not enough volunteers to serve in the military.

If you are forced to serve in either the Danish Armed Forces or the Danish Emergency Management Agency, you can refuse both services and apply to serve your military service through the draft-rejecting scheme. In this case, you must serve your military service by, for example, working in public institutions or emergency relief organizations.

If you voluntarily serve your military service, you can choose to be in either the Armed Forces or the Emergency Management Agency. Military service usually lasts four months in the Armed Forces and nine months in the Emergency Management Agency. As part of the desire to strengthen the Danish defense, it has also been agreed that conscripts from 2026 will serve for 11 months as a starting point.

In 2024, there were approximately 3,600 men serving in the Armed Forces, and approximately 1,100 women doing voluntary service. In the Emergency Service, in 2024, there were approximately 420 men serving in the Armed Forces, and approximately 110 women doing voluntary service – a total of approximately 530. Previously, the need for conscripts was even greater, and there were therefore more conscripts in the Armed Forces than today. For example, it was approx. 24,000 in 1970, 10,500 in 1990, but that number fell to approx. 4,300 towards 2015. In recent years, the number has increased slightly (to 4,700 in 2024). And it has been decided in 2024 that even more will be called up soldiers, so that the number of conscripted soldiers must be increased to 7,500.



Conscripts in the Danish Defense

Fact sheet 17:

Religion and church

In Denmark, you can choose your own religion, and you have the right to practice your religion as long as you respect some basic rules. You can also freely choose to change your religion. And you can choose not to have a religion at all. There is freedom of religion in Denmark. It was confirmed in the constitution in 1849.

There are many different beliefs*. Some believe in something divine, and others base their views on other values. Regardless of whether you are religious or not, as a citizen of Denmark you have the same rights and duties.

This chapter is about:

- The Danish National Church
- Other religious communities in Denmark

THE DANISH FOLK CHURCH

According to the Constitution, the Evangelical Lutheran Church is the Danish national church.

The Danish Church is thus Protestant, and has been so since Denmark broke* with the Catholic Church after the Reformation in 1536.

The state supports* the Danish Church financially. State and church are not separated in Denmark, as they are in a number of other countries. Although the Danish Church is supported by the state, it has no political power. There is a tradition of drawing* a clear line between religion and politics. Most Danes

considers religion to be a private matter.

Most citizens in Denmark (approximately 71 percent in 2025) are members of the Danish National Church. Many Danes primarily use the church for baptisms*, confirmations*, weddings and funerals. Some Danes also go to church on Christmas Eve, December 24th.



Village church in Denmark.

Membership in the Folkekirken is voluntary. You can only become a member by being baptized*. Most members have been baptized as children. But

You are free to opt out if you wish. And parents can also choose not to have their child baptized. If the children later wish to become members of the Danish People's Church, they must first be baptized.

Members of the Danish National Church pay church tax, which is used to maintain* the churches and cemeteries, among other things. If you are not a member, you do not pay church tax to the Danish National Church. However, part of the expenses of the church, including some of the salaries of priests and the salaries of bishops, are paid by all citizens through their taxes.

Even if you are not a member of the Danish Church, you can still get married in the Danish Church. You can do this if the person you are marrying is a member. Everyone can be buried in a Danish cemetery, even people who are not members of the Danish Church. However, you can only have a church funeral with a priest officiating if you are a member.

If you are not a member of the Danish People's Church, you can have a civil funeral. A civil funeral can, for example, take place in the church chapel* or in a community center. At a civil funeral, the relatives* must be responsible for the funeral ritual themselves and, for example, arrange speeches, music and songs.

The Danish Church also has other tasks: e.g. registering births, naming and deaths.

OTHER FAITH COMMUNITIES

A group of citizens can freely form a congregation* or a religious community* in Denmark, as long as they comply with some basic rules. This is stated in the Danish Constitution. The state cannot therefore prohibit such a religious community.

You can apply for recognition* of your congregation or religious community. Once a congregation or religious community is approved, a priest (or other religious leader) can apply for authorization* to perform weddings. This way, followers can have a religious wedding that is also civilly valid.

A recognized congregation or a recognized religious community and its members also have some financial advantages. For example, members of recognized congregations and religious communities have the right, with certain restrictions, to deduct their financial contributions to the religious community from their taxes.

But on the other hand, more is also required when a congregation or religious community is to be recognized. For example, special requirements* are made for its organization, accounting, management, training of priests or religious preachers, and the right of members to freely resign.

There are 436 recognized religious communities and congregations in Denmark. They are very different in size and include many different religions. The vast majority are Christian, but there are also Muslim, Buddhist, Hindu and Jewish religious communities. Many of the world's religions are found in Denmark.

Fact sheet 18:

Denmark and the world

Denmark is a member of several international organizations. In this way, Denmark has influence on the world outside Denmark. At the same time, decisions, taken in international organizations, influence the framework* for the Danish society. The EU – the European Union – has the greatest influence. But also decisions in the UN (United Nations) are important. In addition, Denmark cooperates with other countries and autonomous regions in the Nordic region.

This fact sheet is about:

- EU – the European Union
- UN – United Nations
- Denmark and the Nordic countries
- International cooperation on development

EU – EUROPEAN UNION

Denmark is a member of the EU. The EU is an economic, political and legal* cooperation between 27 European countries. The EU's headquarters are in Brussels, Belgium. The member states cooperate on issues such as the environment, consumer issues and free trade between the countries.



The 27 member states of the EU. Graphics: EU.

Denmark became a member of the EU, or EC as it was then called, in 1973. This happened after a referendum in which the Danes had to vote yes or no on whether Denmark should be a member. Then, as now, there were both opponents and supporters of membership among the population.

Since Denmark became a member, the EU has gained influence in more and more areas. And the EU today has influence on large parts of the legislation in the countries that are member of the EU.

The member states cooperate on, among other things, the environment, consumer issues and free trade between the countries. 19 of the 27 EU countries have a common currency – the euro. Denmark is not part of the common currency, but has chosen to keep the Danish currency (the krone).

Every five years, there are elections to the European Parliament, an important institution in the EU. You must be a citizen of an EU country to vote for the European Parliament.

THE EU'S INFLUENCE ON DANISH POLITICS

Since Denmark became a member, the EU has gained influence in more and more areas. And the EU today has influence on large parts of the legislation in the countries that are member of the EU – including Denmark.

For example, the EU has a major influence on economic policy in Denmark. This means, among other things, that the EU has set limits on how large the deficit can be in the Danish state budget.

The EU also has great influence in many other areas, such as agricultural policy. and environmental policy. But Denmark also has influence on EU policy. Danish ministers and civil servants participate in the meetings in the EU where EU policies and legislation are determined*.

THE DANISH RESERVATIONS

In 1992, there was a referendum in Denmark on a new EU treaty (the Maastricht Treaty), which was supposed to give the EU more influence over the affairs of the member states.

The Danes were to vote yes or no on, among other things, whether Denmark should participate in closer economic cooperation with the other EU countries, and whether there should be a common currency. A majority voted no to the new EU treaty.

The other EU countries said yes to the new EU treaty. The Danish government therefore decided to negotiate with the other EU countries to obtain some Danish exemptions*. This meant that Denmark was given some reservations, i.e. some areas, where Denmark is not involved in the cooperation between EU countries.

Denmark's reservations concern, among other things:

- The common currency, the euro. This reservation means that Denmark does not have the euro as currency.
- Judicial cooperation. This reservation means that Denmark does not participate in the joint EU cooperation on, for example, new common EU rules on police, criminal law, asylum, immigration, divorce and custody.

Denmark can decide for itself whether to abolish* one or more of the reservations.

The reservations can be removed after a new referendum in which the Danish population votes to abolish them.

Previously, Denmark also had a reservation regarding the EU's defense and security policy, so that Denmark, for example, did not participate in military operations that are part of EU cooperation. This so-called 'defense reservation' was lifted as a result of a referendum on June 1, 2022. A majority of 67 percent voted yes to lifting the reservation, while a minority of 33 percent voted no.

THE EU'S MAIN INSTITUTIONS AND DENMARK'S REPRESENTATION IN THE EU

The EU's overall* political guidelines* are adopted* in the European Council (EU summits). The Danish Prime Minister participates here together with the heads of state and government from the other EU countries.

Like the other EU member states, Denmark sends a Commissioner to the European Commission. The European Commission is divided into different policy areas – e.g. environment, economy and agriculture. Each area is headed by a Commissioner, and each EU country has an EU Commissioner. The Commissioners

do not act as representatives of the country they come from and must work independently* of the interests of their own country.

The Council of Ministers consists of representatives of all member states.

governments. When there is a meeting in the

Council of Ministers, the ministers of the member states for the area in question participate. For example, the Danish Minister of the Environment participates together with the environment ministers from the other EU countries in the Council of Ministers' meetings on environmental policy.



Denmark's EU Commissioner Dan Jørgensen.
Photo: Olivier Hoslet/Ritzau Scanpix.

The different countries in the EU also take turns holding a so-called presidency of the Council of Ministers. This rotates every six months, and the country holding the "EU presidency" chairs the meetings of the Council and a wide range of committees and committees.

Denmark holds the presidency of the EU from July 1 to December 31, 2025. The last Danish EU presidency was in 2012.

The European Parliament is directly elected by the people of the 27 EU member states. Elections are held every five years. The European Parliament has a total of 720 members, of which 15 are elected in Denmark. There is typically a lower turnout in elections to the European Parliament than in elections to the Danish Parliament. The voter turnout in Denmark in the 2024 European Parliament elections was 58 percent. In the 2022 Danish Parliament elections, the voter turnout was almost 84 percent.

The EU also has a court: the Court of Justice of the European Union. It has extensive rights both to interpret* the EU Treaty and to rule on legal cases concerning EU rules. The Court of Justice has played a major role in the practical development of EU cooperation.



THE COUNCIL OF EUROPE AND THE EUROPEAN HUMAN COURT OF JUSTICE

The Council of Europe is an independent organization consisting of 47 European countries. Denmark has been a member since the beginning in 1949. The Council of Europe has, among other things, adopted* the European Convention on Human Rights.

It contains a number of fundamental rights, which to some extent correspond to the rights known from the Danish Constitution, such as freedom of expression and freedom of assembly. It also contains other rights, such as the prohibition of torture and the right to a fair trial.

UN – UNITED NATIONS

The UN was founded in 1945, shortly after the end of World War II. Denmark has been a member from the beginning. The UN is an association of almost all states in the world, a total of 193. The UN's purpose is to create peace and development in the world. The UN works, among other things, to help in the event of major disasters (e.g. hunger and natural disasters). The UN also tries to help in the fight against illiteracy and diseases.

The UN also works to promote human rights in all countries in the world.

This applies, for example, to freedom of religion and freedom of expression as well as the prohibition of torture and discrimination.

These are rights that to a certain extent correspond to the rights in the European Convention on Human Rights.

The rights also include the right of ethnic, religious and linguistic minorities to have their own culture, to practice their own religion and to use their own language.

UN SECURITY COUNCIL

The UN has a Security Council. The UN Security Council plays a major role in the work for world peace. France, China, Russia, Great Britain and the United States have permanent seats on the Security Council.

The Security Council has ten other member states. They are elected for two-year terms.

Denmark is a member of the Security Council for the period 2025-26 and has previously been a member in the periods 1967-68, 1985-86 and 2005-06.

The Security Council is responsible for maintaining* international peace and order. The UN Security Council can, for example, ask member states to change something in their policies, for example towards certain population groups.

The Security Council can also impose economic or military sanctions against a country that, for example, oppresses* its own population, produces illegal weapons, or attacks other countries. The Security Council can also use military force if it believes that a particular country poses a threat* to international security.

UN'S 17 GLOBAL GOALS

At a summit in New York in September 2015, the UN member states adopted the new Sustainable Development Goals. The 17 goals apply to all countries in the world – and thus also to Denmark.

In addition to combating poverty and social development, the SDGs also focus on economic development, gender equality, climate, peace and security. With the SDGs, UN member states have committed to, among other things, ending extreme poverty, ensuring education for all, better health, good jobs

and sustainable growth in all countries.



The UN's 17 global goals.

DENMARK AND THE NORDIC COUNTRIES

The Nordic region includes the countries of Denmark, Norway, Sweden, Finland and Iceland, as well as the autonomous territories of the Faroe Islands, Greenland (under Denmark) and the Åland Islands (under Finland). Denmark cooperates with the other Nordic countries. Cooperation takes place in the legal, cultural, social and economic fields, among other things.

Nordic cooperation takes place, among other things, in the Nordic Council and the Nordic Council of Ministers.

INTERNATIONAL DEVELOPMENT COOPERATION

Denmark provides financial support to developing countries every year. This is called development assistance. Denmark is one of the countries in the world that pays the most in development assistance in relation to the size of its population. The assistance* in 2025 is approximately 22 billion kroner, corresponding to 0.7 percent of the so-called gross national income (GNI).

Denmark's development assistance aims, among other things, to combat poverty, create jobs, trade and investment, support the green transition, support the rights of women and girls, and create development in the world's poorest countries.

The assistance is provided, among other things, for development activities carried out in cooperation with

work with the authorities in developing countries. Denmark can also carry out development activities and humanitarian assistance together with international organizations and private aid organizations, e.g. DanChurchAid or the Red Cross.

Africa is the continent that receives the majority of Denmark's development assistance.

This is due, among other things, to the fact that Africa is a neighbor to Europe, and that what happens in Africa can have a major impact on Europe (and thus on Denmark).

There are big differences between the 54 African countries, but overall, Africa is the world's poorest continent, with civil wars and other conflicts in several places.

And it is in Africa that some of the worst consequences of climate change are being felt, in the form of, for example, floods, extreme heat, crop failures in agriculture and several areas of desert.

Africa's population is also growing very rapidly. On the one hand, this creates opportunities for more economic growth, more trade and more investment, but also for greater problems such as poverty, war and climate change.

The Danish government has therefore presented a new and comprehensive 'Strategy for a strengthened Danish engagement with African countries' in 2024. The strategy is intended to further contribute to creating economic growth, trade with Danish companies, combating climate change and resolving conflicts. Another objective is also to contribute to preventing and slowing down refugee flows towards Europe.



Minister of Foreign Affairs Lars Løkke Rasmussen visits Photo: Finn one cocoa plantation in Ghana.
Frandsen/Ritzau Scanpix.

Fact sheet 19:

Denmark's

geography

and population

Denmark is located in the northern part of Europe. Norway is located north of Denmark, and Sweden is located northeast of Denmark. South of Denmark are Germany and Poland.

The Faroe Islands and Greenland are part of the Danish Realm*. The Faroe Islands and Greenland largely regulate* their own societies within the framework of the Faroese Home Rule system and the Greenlandic Self-Government system. The Faroe Islands and Greenland have their own democratic assemblies*.

At the same time, Faroese and Greenlanders are Danish citizens and elect representatives to the Folketing in Denmark. Two members are elected in the Faroe Islands and two members in Greenland.

This section is about:

- Geography of Denmark
- Denmark's population

GEOGRAPHY OF DENMARK

Denmark is geographically a small country. Its area is only a little more than 43,000 km². km², not counting Greenland and the Faroe Islands.

Denmark consists of the peninsula of Jutland and over 400 larger and smaller islands. The largest island is Zealand. The many islands mean that Denmark has a very long coastline – around 7,300 km.

The largest body of water* around Denmark is the North Sea, which in Denmark is also called the North Sea because it lies west of Denmark. To the north of Denmark is the Skagerrak. To the southeast of the Skagerrak and north of Zealand and Funen is the Kattegat.

The waters between Jutland and Funen are called the Little Belt, while the waters between Funen and Zealand are called the Great Belt. The waters between Zealand and Sweden are called the Sound.

There are many bridges and tunnels in Denmark. Some of the most important are:

- The Little Belt Bridges, connecting Jutland and Funen across the waters of the Little Belt
- The Great Belt Link, which connects Funen and Zealand across the waters of the Great Belt belt
- The Øresund Bridge, which connects Denmark and Sweden across the waters Sound

The northernmost point in Denmark is called Grenen, and it is located northeast of the city of Skagen in North Jutland. At Grenen, the two waters of Skagerrak and Kattegat meet.

The southernmost point in Denmark is Gedser Odde on the island of Falster. Gedser Odde is located on the Baltic Sea.



Nyhavn in Copenhagen. Photo: Tue Schou Pedersen.

The westernmost point in Denmark is Blåvands Huk in West Jutland. Blåvands Huk is located on the North Sea (Vasterhavet).

The easternmost point in Denmark is the Ertholmene archipelago, which lies east of Bornholm in the Baltic Sea.

Denmark is a flat country with no mountains. The highest natural point in Denmark called Møllehøj and is located in East Jutland approximately 170 meters above sea level. A Much of the country is covered* by fields, and in some places there is forest. One of the few places where there are cliffs in Denmark is on the island of Bornholm.

DENMARK'S POPULATION

There are approximately six million people living in Denmark. Of these, almost one million are (16 percent) immigrants or descendants*. Most people live in the cities. The capital Copenhagen is the largest city and is located on Zealand. Today, approximately two million people (about a third of Denmark's population) live in the metropolitan area, that is, in Copenhagen itself and in the municipalities surrounding Copenhagen.

The second largest city is Aarhus, which is located in East Jutland. The city has approx. 280,000 inhabitants. The third largest city in Denmark is Odense on Funen with approx. 180,000 inhabitants. The fourth largest city is Aalborg, which is located in North Jutland and has approx. 120,000 inhabitants. And Esbjerg in West Jutland is the fifth largest city with approximately 72,000 inhabitants.

Fact sheet 20:

Denmark's history before 1945

Today's Denmark covers an area of approximately 43,000 km² and has a population of approximately six million.

400 years ago it was different. At that time the Danish king ruled over a kingdom that included Norway, Iceland and areas that now belong to Germany and Sweden. The population spoke Danish, Norwegian, German and Icelandic, among other languages. Compared to the past, when the country was a major power in the Nordic countries and the area around the Baltic Sea, Denmark is today a smaller nation-state.

This fact sheet is about:

- Important periods, events and people in Danish history before 1945

EARLY HISTORY

Around 12,500 BC, people began to arrive in the area where Denmark is now located. The first people who came lived by hunting and fishing. Several thousand years

Later – around 4,000 BC – people switched to cultivating the land and keeping livestock.

Just over 2,000 years ago, it became common to live together in villages. And from around 700 AD, real towns such as Ribe emerged.

VIKING AGE (CA. 750 –1050)

Soon thereafter, larger and larger parts of Denmark were ruled by a king.

King Harald Bluetooth, who died in 987, erected a runestone in Jelling. It says that it was he, Harald Bluetooth, who united Denmark into one kingdom. This stone can still be seen in Jelling in Jutland. The stone is called Denmark's baptismal certificate* because it also says that Harald Bluetooth converted the Danes to Christianity.

Until now, the people of Denmark had practiced a Nordic religion called 'asatro'. This means belief in the Aesir, who were gods. The king of the gods was called Odin. He is often described as a

an elderly man with only one eye and two ravens sitting on his shoulders. Among the other gods in the Asatru faith can be mentioned Freya, who was the goddess of fertility*. Furthermore, there were thunder and



The Jelling Stone.

the god of war Thor, who drove across the sky with his chariot, which was believed to be what you could hear when it thundered.

The period from about 750 to about 1050 is named after the Vikings. They were warriors from Scandinavia (Denmark, Norway and Sweden) who sailed on expeditions* to other countries, such as England, Ireland, France and Russia. And in 1013 the Danish king Sweyn Forkbeard succeeded in conquering England. For the next 30 years or so – until 1042 – England was ruled by several Danish kings. The most important was Canute the Great, who reigned between 1018 and 1035.

The Viking ships were fast; they had sails and oars, and they had a flat bottom, so they could sail directly onto the beach. The Vikings got a lot of war booty* with home from their voyages. Denmark became richer during this period. Several cities arose (Odense, Aalborg and Aarhus), and the large, round Viking castles, such as Trelleborg and Fyrkat, also date from this time.

THE MIDDLE AGES (CA. 1050-CA. 1500)

During the Viking Age, the king had gained more and more power. The richest men in the country, the magnates, were dissatisfied with this, so there were often conflicts between them and the king. In 1086 a conflict ended with the nobles beating King Canute the Holy One was killed. This meant that for a time the strong royal power was over. The kings then became more dependent on the nobles than they had been before.

Christianity came to Denmark under King Harald Bluetooth, who himself was baptized* around 965. For the first 5-600 years after Denmark became Christian, the Danish church was part of the Roman Catholic Church. Bishops, priests and monks worked to spread Christianity in the country, and the church gained greater and greater power. The center of faith was the town or village church, and by around 1250, close to 3,000 churches had been built in Denmark. Monasteries were also built all over the country.



Bellinge Church on Funen is a of Denmark's many churches from the Middle Ages.
Photo: Arnold Mikkelsen/National Museum.

The church was rich and owned a large part of the Danish land. The king was now not only dependent on the nobles, but also on the church.

Four classes or estates emerged in Danish society during the Middle Ages:

- The clergy (priests and other church figures)
- The nobility (great men who owned land and were obliged to provide military service)
- The citizens (e.g. craftsmen and traders who lived in the cities)
- The farmers

In the Middle Ages, Europe and Denmark were hit by the plague – a disease that killed many people. This happened around 1350. Approximately one third of Denmark's population died. This led to major economic and social changes in Danish society. The king gained more power again – partly because he often took over the land that belonged to people who died of the plague.

In 1397, Denmark, Norway and Sweden were united in a union. It was called the Kalmar Union because it was concluded in the Swedish city of Kalmar. Of decisive importance for the formation of this union was Margrete I, who held power in the three kingdoms until her death in 1412. The three countries were united in the Kalmar Union until 1523.

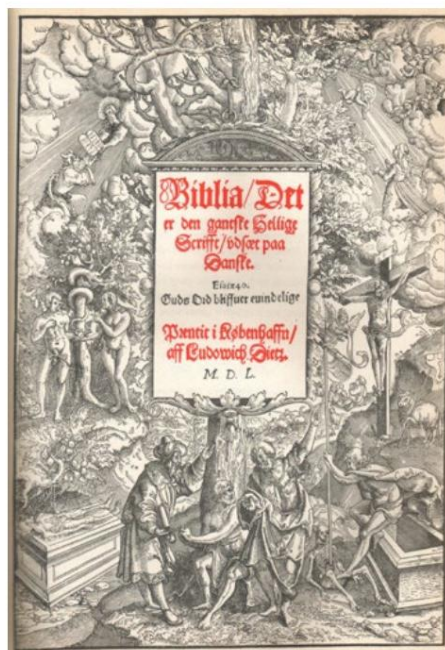
Denmark and Norway continued to be in union together until 1814.

THE REFORMATION (1536)

The Danish Church broke* with the Catholic Church and the Pope in Rome in 1536. This event is called the Reformation. With the Reformation, Protestantism was introduced in Denmark. The Church became a state church with the king as its head.

This meant, among other things, that the king took over the church's land, about a third of the country's cultivated area. The Reformation strengthened* the king's power and at the same time gave the nobility increased influence over the church's expense.

In addition, the Bible was also translated into Danish, and church services* and hymn singing were from now on only held in Danish. In the Middle Ages, the church had especially used Latin, which only a few people understood.



The first Bible in Danish from 1550.

Photo: National Museum.

THE RENAISSANCE (CA. 1536 – CA. 1660)

During the period known as the Renaissance, Denmark was often at war with its neighbor Sweden. The two countries fought for power in the area around the Baltic Sea. Denmark suffered many major defeats* in these wars.

This meant, among other things, that Denmark lost Scania, Halland and Blekinge to Sweden in 1658.

Christian IV is one of the most well-known kings throughout Danish history.

He was king for almost 60 years from 1588 to 1648. He is known for, among other things,

his great passion for building. The Stock Exchange, the Round Tower and Rosenborg Castle – all three in Copenhagen – are among Christian IV's most famous buildings.



Tower, the Stock Exchange, Rosenborg Castle and – of Copenhagen – are among Christian IV's most famous buildings.

AUTOCRACY AND AGRICULTURE THE FORMS (1660 – 1848)

The many defeats and the loss of Skåne, Halland and Blekinge led to a political crisis in Denmark. The result of the crisis was that the country got a new

form of government in 1660-61. Before that time, Denmark was an elective monarchy, meaning that the king was elected by the nobility. Instead

of an elective monarchy, in 1660 a hereditary monarchy was established. The king's power was to be now automatically passed on within the royal family. Most often it was the king's eldest son who inherited the title of king. The king also became absolute. This happened in 1661.

This meant that the king had full power in the country. He could rule independently of the nobility. The autocracy lasted until 1848.

At the end of the 18th century, a number of agricultural reforms were implemented in Denmark, which had a great impact on Danish society. In 1788, it was so-called "Stavnsbånd" abolished. The stavnsbånd had forced most farmers to work for a specific landowner and live in a specific place. The reforms therefore meant, among other things, that the peasants could now decide for themselves where they wanted to work and live. The reforms also meant that the peasants could own their own land instead of renting it from the landowner. And this meant that a new group emerged in society: independent farmers.

The land reforms also had an impact on where the farmers' farms were located. Before the land reforms, the farmers lived together in villages and cultivated the land around the village together. Now the individual farm was often moved from the village to the countryside.

the very field that the farmer cultivated. This is still visible in the Danish landscape, where many farms lie by themselves in the middle of the land that belongs to the farm.

The new, independent farmers gained greater economic freedom, but they had to

The rest of the population had no political rights. It was still the king who decided everything.

DEMOCRACY (1849)

From the end of the 18th century and through the first half of the 19th century, ideas about freedom for the individual citizen and equality between people spread.

In Denmark, dissatisfaction with the king's absolute power grew. People wanted

instead a democratic constitution that limited the king's power. The constitution was to ensure that the population had influence* on the decisions made in

the country.



Demonstration in Copenhagen in 1848 for a democratic constitution.

In 1848, King Frederik VII gave in to the demand for democracy. He gave up his absolute power and declared himself a constitutional king. This led to Denmark's first free constitution, the Constitution of the Kingdom of Denmark of 5 June 1849. The constitution meant that Denmark had two legislative assemblies: the Folketinget and the Landstinget, which together was called the Riksdag. The population could vote on who would sit in the Riksdag, and thus had influence on legislation in Denmark.

However, the Constitution of 1849 did not mean that all citizens gained political influence.

For example, women, the poor and men under 30 could not vote for the Riksdag. This

They only got the opportunity later, in connection with the amendment of the constitution in 1915. But compared to most other states' constitutions at that time,

The Danish constitution is very democratic.

A SMALL COUNTRY (1864 – 1914)

In connection with a war between the German Confederation and Denmark in 1864, Denmark lost the two duchies of Schleswig and Holstein. These two areas had long been part of the Danish kingdom. Now Denmark became much smaller.

Therefore, it became important to use what was left of Denmark's land in the best possible way to create growth. For example, people started cultivating the Jutland heath. And many farmers began breeding animals instead of just growing grain, because they could earn much more money on, for example, butter, pork and eggs than on grain products.



Painting of a clothing factory in Copenhagen in the late 19th century.

From the 1840s, railways were built in Denmark. This meant that goods and people could suddenly be transported much faster than before. And after 1870, industrialization also began to proceed much faster. The many new factories, which were usually located in the cities, needed a lot of labor. This meant, among other things, that many poor farm workers moved to the cities to work. There arose

thus a new population group: the working class. And during the 1870s a political workers' party, the Social Democrats, was also formed.

Several of the current parties in the Folketing were formed in the late 19th century and early 20th century. Most farmers rallied around the Liberal Party, which was formed in 1870, while the landowners, the more well-off people in the cities and employees in the police, the army and civil servants typically voted for the Right, which in 1915-16 became the Conservative People's Party. In 1905, a number of members of the Left left seceded and formed the Radical Left, which was mainly voted for by homesteaders* and academics in the larger cities.

NEUTRALITY AND OCCUPATION (1914 – 1945)



German aircraft over Copenhagen, April 9, 1940.

Denmark was neutral during World War I (1914 – 1918). During World War II, German troops occupied* Denmark on April 9, 1940. The government decided to bow* and was forced to cooperate with the German occupation forces. The popular resistance against the German occupation forces gradually became so great that cooperation with Germany broke* down in August 1943. The government submitted its resignation*, and the Danish army was disbanded.

The last year and a half of the war was characterized* by growing resistance to the German occupation. The Germans and their Danish collaborators were attacked in various actions, using weapons and explosives*. Denmark was officially liberated by British troops on May 5, 1945.



Celebration of the liberation after five years of German occupation in Copenhagen on May 5, 1945.

Fact sheet 21:

Denmark's history after 1945

This fact sheet is about:

- Important periods, events and people in Danish history after 1945

THE COLD WAR

After World War II, Denmark stopped its policy of neutrality* and in 1949 became a member of the NATO defense alliance. Denmark had also tried to remain neutral during World War II, but was occupied by Germany. The alliance consisted of the United States, Canada and a number of countries in Western Europe. Opposing NATO was the Warsaw Pact with the Soviet Union and a number of countries in Eastern Europe. By joining NATO, Denmark chose a side in the Cold War, between the two new superpowers, the United States and the Soviet Union. The Cold War was, among other things, a fight over who had the biggest and best military and the most nuclear weapons. But it was also a fight between two different political ideologies – on the one hand the liberal market economy of the West* and on the other hand the communist planned economy of the Soviet Union*.

From 1948 to 1951, the United States gave large sums of money – with the so-called Marshall Plan – to a number of countries in Western Europe, including Denmark. The money from the Marshall Plan was to rebuild the many cities, houses, roads, factories, etc. that were destroyed during World War II. And the United States' plan was to prevent* the spread of communism to several countries. However, the Danish Communist Party never got long-term success among the voters, and in 1958-59 a large group of the party's members left and formed the Socialist People's Party (SF).

The financial aid from the United States helped modernize Danish agriculture after World War II. They received tractors, combines and other machinery instead for horses. As a result, a large part of the rural workforce* became unnecessary, so many moved from the countryside to the cities in the 1950s to find work there.



Soviet troops on duty in Poland, Canadian troops on exercise in West Germany, and during the

ECONOMIC GROWTH AND WELFARE STATE

From the end of the 1950s there was high economic growth* in Europe and also in Denmark. From 1957 to 1973 the Danes experienced a very large economic progress. Production grew, and there was enough work for almost everyone. Most people had more money, and many could now afford to buy TVs, refrigerators, washing machine, car, summer house or going on holiday abroad. The period is therefore also called 'The Happy 60s'.

Public sector welfare was also expanded. This was especially the case in the 1960s and The 1970s saw the Danish state become the welfare state we know today. Among other things, there was the introduction of the "Folkepension", which means a pension for all elderly people, and more nurseries, kindergartens and nursing homes were built. There were also many more, who could pursue education after primary school, that is, they went to high school, vocational schools and trade schools and trained, for example, to become nurses, teachers or engineers.

Many women entered the labor market during the same period. In the mid-1900s In the past, the vast majority of married women had taken care of the home and children, while the men went to work outside the home. From the 1960s, more women received education and work, while many more children were cared for in one of the many new crèches, kindergartens and after-school centers. Labor* was also brought in from abroad, and many foreigners came to Denmark to work. Most came from Turkey, ex-Yugoslavia or Pakistan.

YOUTH REBELLION AND WOMEN'S MOVEMENT

From the late 1960s, many young people rebelled* against societal norms and values that they believed were old-fashioned. For example, they believed that a family could be different from a "nuclear family" with mother, father and children, and new ways of living together became more accepted: couples could live together without being married, and some created collectives, where many adults and children lived together and had joint finances.



Young people at a festival in Copenhagen in 1971.

Photo: Jørgen Riis/Scanpix

Sex before marriage also became more accepted, and in 1966 the contraceptive pill was introduced in Denmark. Now women could control when they became pregnant, and the pill became very important for women's sexual freedom. Students at the universities rebelled and wanted to influence* the teaching of new subjects.

methods and the content of the studies. The traditional upbringing of children in families and schools was replaced by a new pedagogy, where the child and adults cooperated more. In 1967, it was forbidden to hit children in school. However, it was not until 30 years later, in 1997, that parents were forbidden to hit their own children.

The women's movement, such as the 'redstockings movement*', grew strong, and equality between men and women was an important political issue in the 1970s. A very important victory for the women's movement was when free abortion was introduced in 1973, so that women could now choose for themselves whether they wanted to terminate a pregnancy (up to the 12th week of pregnancy). Free abortion still applies, and in 2025 the limit for free abortion has been raised from the 12th to the 18th week of pregnancy.

Another important victory was when the Danish Parliament passed an equal pay law in 1976, giving men and women the right to the same pay for the same work. Previously, it had been legal for women to earn less than their male colleagues. For example, women making shoes in 1971 earned 549 kroner per week, while men earned 630 kroner per week, even though they were doing the same work.

EU, CRISIS AND IMMIGRATION

In 1973, Denmark became a member of the European Community (EU). This happened after a referendum in which the Danes had to vote yes or no on whether Denmark should be a member. A majority of 63.4 percent voted yes to the EC. For the yes voters, it was important that Denmark had better opportunities to trade with other European countries, and that Danish agriculture could receive financial support from the EC. The no-votes believed that Denmark gave up some of its right to self-determination and that membership would affect the welfare state and the national identity of the Danes*.

During the 1970s, Denmark, like many other Western countries, was hit by an economic crisis. The crisis came mainly because the price of oil rose sharply in 1973 and again in 1979 due to wars and political problems in the Middle East. Oil was used in industry and for heating homes, and Denmark produced very little oil at the time.

The Social Democrats had been in government and held the post of prime minister for most of (a total of 41) years between 1929 and 1982, while the bourgeois parties (Venstre and the Conservative People's Party) had only formed governments for short periods. But in 1982 Denmark got a bourgeois government that lasted for over ten years (until 1993). Since 1982, there have been a total of 17 years with a Social Democratic prime minister and 24 years with a bourgeois prime minister. Important political issues throughout the 1980s were Denmark's economic problems with public budget deficits and Denmark's foreign trade.



former Prime Ministers, Poul Nyrup Lars Løkke Rasmussen (2001-09), Poul Schlüter (1982-93), and Rasmussen (2001-09) arrive at the funeral of the fifth Prime Minister, Poul Schlüter (1982-93).

Photo: Martin Sylvest/Scanpix Ritzau.

There were also strong political movements such as the peace movement, which worked against armaments* and the arms race* between the great powers, and the environmental movement, which was, for example, against nuclear power. In 1985, the Danish Parliament decided that no nuclear power plants should be built in Denmark.

In the 1980s, more and more immigrants came to Denmark, and in larger Danish cities there were districts where many residents had an ethnic background other than Danish. At the same time, many refugees and immigrants had difficulty finding work and get an education. Many Danes felt that some immigrants had a very different culture and that they were not always good enough to learn the Danish language. During the 1990s, the discussion about immigrants increasingly filled the public debate. The desire for changes in immigration and integration policy meant that the Danish People's Party was elected to the Folketing for the first time in 1998. The discussion continued into the new millennium and various Danish governments tightened immigration policy. The tightening meant, among other things,

- that it became more difficult to bring foreign family to the country (family reunification)
- that newly arrived unemployed people could not receive full cash benefits but received a lower amount
- that one should have lived in Denmark for a longer period of time in order to obtain Danish nationality (citizenship) and have had a job most of the time, not committed serious crime, learned the Danish language and had knowledge of Danish history, society, culture and Danish values such as democracy and equality.

NEW ECONOMIC CHALLENGES

During the 1990s, Denmark's economy began to improve. The economy grew faster, more people were employed, and the state once again had more revenue* than expenses*. The production of oil and gas from the North Sea also meant that Denmark could sell more oil and gas abroad than the country bought.

After about 15 years of good economy, Denmark was hit by an international financial crisis in 2008. The crisis started in the USA, but quickly spread to Europe. In Denmark the value of the country's total output fell by five percent in 2008-09. This was the biggest decline for the Danish economy since World War II. The crisis meant that more people became unemployed. When the crisis began, unemployment was the lowest in 30 years. years, and there was a large surplus in the state budget. Later there were deficits, but Denmark did not have as big problems with deficits and debt. like many other European countries. From around 2015, the state budget has again turned a surplus, and unemployment in Denmark has fallen.

One of the biggest problems for Denmark and most other European countries is, that there will be many more elderly people compared to the number of people of that age (15 to 64 years), where you typically work and pay taxes. This is due firstly to the fact that the population is living longer, so we are getting older and older, but also to the fact that fewer children are being born than before.

In 2024, women in Denmark could expect to live 83.7 years compared to 76.6 years in 1973-74. Men could expect to live 79.9 years compared to 70.8 years in 1973-74. During the same period, the birth rate fell, meaning that each woman gave birth to fewer children on average (1.5 in 2024 and 1.9 in 1973). In addition, most people today start working at a later age, because they are training for more years than before. That is why the last 35 years or so have made a number of political reforms that will bring more people into the labor market. For example, you have to be older than before to retire, and the period during which you can get financial help from the unemployment fund (a-kasse) if you become unemployed has become shorter. And the tax on earned income has been lowered to make it more attractive to work.



Pensioners on balcony in apartment in Copenhagen.

Photo: Christian Lindgren/Ritzau Scanpix.

CORONA

A significant challenge in the years 2020-22 was the disease covid-19 – also known as corona. The disease was discovered in China in 2019, and in Denmark the first case was registered in February 2020. The government, the Folketing, the Danish Health Authority and others tried to combat the disease with various measures to combat the risk of infection, including, for example, that people were not together with too many other people, that people kept their distance from each other, and that they sanitized their hands. In this way, they tried to prevent* too many people from becoming infected at once, so that there were no more people who had to be treated at the same time than the hospitals had room for.

You also couldn't travel as freely between Denmark and abroad as usual.

Schools were also closed for periods, and students were taught at home via the internet. Many restaurants, cafes, museums and theaters were closed for periods, football matches and other sports were held without spectators, and many worked from home. The health service tested thousands of people daily to find those infected.

Another important means of combating the disease was to vaccinate the population. It took only about a year from the beginning of the disease to develop vaccines against coronavirus, and in December 2020 the first Dane was vaccinated. Since then, most people (about 90 percent of the Danish population) have been vaccinated with two or three plugs.



Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen is vaccinated against coronavirus.

Photo: The Prime Minister's Office.

Fact sheet 22:

Danish culture

There is a long tradition of literature, theater, visual arts, music, architecture and film in Denmark.

This fact sheet is about:

- Important figures from Danish culture

18TH CENTURY

Ludvig Holberg (1684-1754) has also been called the 'father of Danish literature'. He grew up in the Norwegian city of Bergen. He moved to Denmark as a young man, where he spent his entire adult life as a professor at the University of Copenhagen. And as a very diligent writer.

He laid the foundation for Danish theatre with comedies such as 'Jeppe på Bjerget'. And he wrote 'Epistler' – that is, short prose texts – about the ideas of the Enlightenment: tolerance, good education, equality between men and women. Holberg became famous in Europe with the novel 'Niels Klim's Underground Journey' (1741), in which, as in the Epistles, he disseminates his philosophical ideas.

19th CENTURY

Hans Christian Andersen (1805-1875) was a Danish author who became world famous for his fairy tales.

Hans Christian Andersen was born in Odense as the son of a poor shoemaker.

He moved to Copenhagen when he was 14. He wrote novels, poems and

fairy tales. HC Andersen's fairy tales have been translated into approximately 125 languages. Among his best-known fairy tales are 'The Spruce Tree' and 'The Ugly Duckling'. These fairy tales show Andersen's special ability to give animals and plants human voices and to use animals and plants to tell stories about people's mistakes and dreams.

Søren Kierkegaard (1813-1855) was a Danish philosopher whose thoughts on human existence has affected people in many countries right up to the present day. He emphasized the right and duty of people to make choices about their own lives. How important is choice for him, one can hear one of his best-known titles, 'Either or Not' (1843).

PS Krøyer (1851-1909) was a Danish painter. PS Krøyer was born in Stavanger, Norway, but he lived most of his life in Denmark. He

was educated at the Academy of Fine Arts in Copenhagen. In the 1880s and 1890s he was part of a group of artists who lived in Skagen in North Jutland to work. The paintings he painted in Skagen are very famous in Denmark, and a number of them can be seen at Skagen Museum.



Hip, hip, hooray! Painted by PS Krøyer in 1888.

1900S

Carl Nielsen (1865-1931) was a Danish composer. He contributed to the international concert hall culture with choral works and symphonies. For example, the symphony 'The Inexhaustible' (1916).

He has also composed music for Danish poems, turning them into widely popular songs such as 'Jens Vejmand', 'The sun is so red, mother', 'The Danish song is a young blond girl'.

Karen Blixen (1885-1962) was a Danish author. Karen Blixen owned and managed a coffee farm in

Kenya. Her experiences on the farm became the basis for her book 'The African Farm', which she wrote in 1937, after the farm was sold and she returned to Denmark. 'The African Farm' has also been filmed in the USA.



Karen Blixen is also known for a special kind of historical short stories, which can be found in, for example, 'Seven Fantastic Tales' (1935).

Another well-known author is Tove Ditlevsen (1917-76). She grew up in a poor family in Vesterbro in Copenhagen, and she dreamed of becoming a poet as a child, even though her father said that girls could not become one. She wrote both poems and novels about being a child, a woman and poor in the society of the time, and among her main works are Barndommens Gade (1943) and the books Barndom (1967), Ungdom (1967) and Gift (1971).

Arne Jacobsen (1902-1971) was a Danish architect known for 'functionalism', that is, the design of houses and furniture that emphasizes what they are to be used for. He designed the National Bank of Denmark in Copenhagen.



Among his furniture, the most widespread is the '7-eren', an everyday chair made of plywood and metal. And it Exclusive armchair named after what it resembles: 'The Egg'.

2000s

Thomas Vinterberg (born 1969) is a Danish film director. Among other things, he has made the film 'Drunk' (2020), which won an Oscar in 2021. In 'Drunk', four high school teachers try to make their lives more exciting by drinking, so that they have alcohol in their blood all day. It goes well at first, but eventually it gets out of control and ends in a tragic accident.

Many of Thomas Vinterberg's films tell stories about dilemmas in the family. Between adults and between parents and children. It can be about sexual abuse, 'The Party' (1998), about false accusations, 'The Hunt' (2012) or about shattered hopes, 'The Collective' (2016).

Another Danish film director, Susanne Bier (born 1960), has also won a Oscar for 'Revenge' (2010), which focuses on the situations in life in which it is right and wrong to take revenge on others.

Denmark has won the Eurovision Song Contest (The European Melodi Grand Prix) three times. The first time was in 1963 with 'Dansevise', which was performed by Grethe Ingmann (1938-90) and Jørgen Ingmann (1925-2015). The second time was in 2000 with 'Smuk som et stjerneskud/Fly on the Wings of Love', written and performed by the duo Brødrene Olsen, consisting of Jørgen Olsen (born 1950) and Niels Olsen (born 1954). The third time was in 2013 with 'Only Teardrops', which was sung by Emmelie de Forest (born 1993).

In the 1990s, the Danish-Norwegian music group Aqua had great success with their pop music. The song 'Barbie Girl' in particular was a global hit. Aqua sold a total of 28 million CDs, making them one of the best-selling Danish bands of all time.



The music group Aqua in 1998.

Another artist is Danish-Icelandic Olafur Eliasson (born 1967). One of his best-known works is 'Your rainbow panorama' (2011) on top of the ARoS art museum in Aarhus, which is a 150-meter-long circular glass walkway from which you can see Aarhus in all the colors of the rainbow.



Panorama, Eliasson Aarhus Art Museum 2011, ARoS Your Rainbow
Photo: Tue Schou Pedersen.

Author Yahya Hassan (1995-2020) debuted with the poetry collection 'Yahya Hassan' (2013). The collection is the poetry collection that has sold the most copies (over 100,000) in Denmark ever. Hassan's poems about growing up and being young as an immigrant in a ghetto neighborhood* created fierce debate because they pointed to problems and clashes between Danish norms and the norms in socially burdened immigrant environments.

Fact sheet 23:

Traditions and anniversaries

As in many other countries, Denmark has a number of days during the year to mark, for example, religious holidays or historical events that have had great significance for Denmark. Often, special traditions are associated with the individual days. On many of these days, people are normally free from work or school.

This fact sheet is about:

- Traditions and anniversaries

MEMORIAL DAYS

Carnival

Fastelavn is another word for carnival.

It is a spring festival that dates back to the ancient Roman Empire and Egypt. Originally*, Shrove Tuesday was the beginning of the Christian Lent*, which began 40 days before Easter.

Nowadays, there is a tradition of celebrating Shrove Tuesday by children dressing up and knocking the cat out of the barrel. It is said that in the old days there was a live cat in the barrel. Today there are sweets and fruit in the barrel. The one who knocks the last board out of the barrel is called the cat king. Shrove Tuesday is seven weeks before Easter.



Easter

Easter is one of the most important holidays in the Christian religion. The Christian Easter marks the crucifixion* and death of Jesus, and his resurrection* from the dead. Easter is celebrated with church services and concerts in churches.

The Easter days are Palm Sunday, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday, Easter Sunday and Easter Monday. All of these days are public holidays, when most people are off work or school. Many families gather for Easter lunches, where they eat a large lunch and often drink a special beer called Easter brew.



From ancient times there has also been a tradition of giving Easter eggs. Today, Easter eggs are often made of chocolate. Easter falls every year in the spring in either March or April, but unlike Christmas, it does not have a fixed date.

Pentecost

Pentecost is celebrated within the Christian tradition seven weeks after Easter. It is celebrated to commemorate the fact that, according to the Bible, the Holy Spirit came to earth on the seventh Sunday after Easter Sunday.

Pentecost falls every year in May or June and includes Whitsunday and Whitsunday, both of which are public holidays. Pentecost services are held in churches all over the country.

May 1

May 1st has been an international workers' day of demonstration and celebration since 1889. May 1st is organized by trade unions and political organizations. It varies from workplace to workplace whether you have the day off. Many schoolchildren have May 1st off.

May 5

On May 5, 1945, Denmark was liberated after five years of German occupation* during World War II. World War. When the news of the German capitulation* came on the evening of May 4, many people removed* the blackout curtains* that were used during the war. And they let the light shine out through all the windows. Many still remember this evening by putting candles in the windows.

Constitution Day

June 5th is Constitution Day. On this day, people celebrate that Denmark's first free constitution* was introduced on June 5th, 1849. Meetings are held all over the country (constitution meetings) where speeches are made about democracy and popular rule. Constitution Day is not an official holiday, but public offices and many shops are closed.

St. John's Day

On the evening of June 23rd, Midsummer is celebrated. The background to Midsummer is a mixture of pagan* folk tradition and Christianity. On Midsummer's Eve, people gather and light a bonfire. In folk tradition, the party marks midsummer.



Christmas

In the Christian tradition, Christmas marks the birth of Jesus. On Christmas Eve, December 24, Christmas services are held, and many children and adults attend church on that day.

In Denmark, people usually have the 24th, 25th and 26th of December off from work and school. These three days are called Christmas Eve, Christmas Day and Boxing Day. In many families, several generations celebrate Christmas Eve together. People have a Christmas tree*, eat a traditional Christmas dinner, dance around the Christmas tree, sing Christmas carols and carols and give each other Christmas presents. In families with children from more than one marriage, Christmas is often celebrated several times, so that the children celebrate Christmas with both their father and their mother. Christmas Day and On Boxing Day, many families gather for Christmas lunch.

In most workplaces and among friends, people celebrate in December. also Christmas parties. There are different traditions for Christmas parties, but common to most is that people eat a lot of food and drink beer and schnapps.



New Year

New Year's Eve is celebrated in Denmark on the evening of December 31st, when many people party with their friends and set off fireworks. Many people traditionally start their New Year's Eve celebrations with the King's New Year's speech, which is shown on television at 6 p.m. On New Year's Day, January 1st, the Prime Minister gives a New Year's speech, which is broadcast on television. On January 1st, the vast majority of workplaces and shops closed.

OTHER ANNIVERSARIES

Ramadan and Eid

As more people in Denmark are Muslims, more institutions are marking different ways of celebrating Eid, i.e. the festival that marks the end of the Muslim fasting month of Ramadan. Ramadan is celebrated in memory of the month in which, according to the Quran, the Prophet Muhammad received his first revelation from Allah via the archangel Gabriel. During the fasting month, many Muslims neither eat nor drink while the sun is in the sky. When Ramadan is over, it is celebrated with a festival called Eid al-Fitr.

Jewish Passover and Pentecost

One of the most important Jewish holidays is the Jewish Passover. It is held, among other things, to commemorate the exodus of the Jews from Egypt. There is a tradition of eating lamb and unleavened bread during the Jewish Passover. During the Jewish Pentecost, the covenant is celebrated on Mount Sinai - where Moses received the Ten Commandments and where the Jews entered into a covenant with God.

Chinese New Year

Other holidays that have come to Denmark through increased cultural exchange include Chinese New Year. Chinese New Year is the most important traditional Chinese holiday. The Chinese New Year starts on the first day of the first month in the Chinese calendar and ends with the Lantern Festival on the 15th day.

Other anniversaries

Some celebrate the American tradition of Halloween, where children dress up as witches, ghosts, etc. Several places in the country also celebrate carnival based on the South American model, with costumes, samba music, and parades.

Fact sheet 24:

Denmark's

defense and

security

policy

In 1945, just after World War II, Denmark became a member of the UN*. In 1949, at the beginning of the Cold War*, Denmark became a member of NATO* together with, among others, the USA and a number of other Western European countries. Membership of the UN and NATO became the basis for Denmark's foreign and security policy after World War II.

This fact sheet is about:

- Denmark's foreign policy since World War II

In the years after World War II and until around 1990, Denmark participated in many of the UN's peacekeeping missions. Denmark sent soldiers to help resolve conflicts and create peace around the world, for example by ensuring that ceasefires were respected and protecting civilians.

After the end of the Cold War (circa 1990), Denmark gradually developed an "activist foreign policy." This meant that Denmark began to participate more actively in international conflicts, including in other than peacekeeping missions.

The Gulf War began in 1990 when Iraq occupied neighboring Kuwait. Based on a UN resolution, the United States led a military operation in 1991 to liberate Kuwait. Denmark sent a ship as a contribution to the international military force. However, the ship did not participate in active military operations.

In the early 1990s, the civil war began in the former Yugoslavia. Danish soldiers were sent here as part of the UN forces. They were supposed to help create peace. In this conflict they came into direct combat with Serbian forces in Bosnia in 1994.

Kosovo, which was then a province of Serbia, also experienced civil war in the late 1990s. The Albanian majority population was subjected to abuses from the government. After long negotiations without result, NATO intervened militarily in 1999. Danish fighter planes participated in NATO's actions.

NEW TARGETS AFTER THE TERRORIST ATTACK ON THE USA

A turning point for NATO and all member states was the terrorist attack on the United States on September 11, 2001. Here, terrorists killed around 3,000 people by hijacking passenger planes and flying them into, among other things, the 'World Trade Center' in New York. After this terrorist attack, international counterterrorism became an important task.

Previously, NATO had only been ready to respond to threats from other nations. But after the terrorist attack, NATO took a new step in its cooperation. NATO also wanted to combat other threats to member states, including terrorist threats from terrorist groups. Denmark therefore participated in military missions around the world in the years after 2001 to combat terrorism. The terrorist organization Al Qaeda,

who was behind the attack on the United States on September 11, 2001, was based in Afghanistan. Therefore, forces led by NATO and mandated by the UN invaded the country in October 2001 and ousted the Islamist Taliban government, which was collaborating with Al Qaeda. In 2002, the Danish Parliament decided to send Danish soldiers to Afghanistan to participate in the war.

The Danish soldiers were sent, together with British soldiers, to the southern Helmand province, which was one of the most turbulent in the country. A total of 44 Danish soldiers lost their lives. After 2014, the task of the Danish soldiers deployed had become to train and support the Afghans so that they could be responsible for the security of the country themselves – and since then the Danish soldiers have been completely withdrawn home. After 20 years of civil war, the Taliban regained power in Afghanistan in 2021.



Danes in Afghanistan.

In 2003, the United States and a number of other countries went to war against Iraq and its dictator Saddam Hussein. The war began because Iraq did not cooperate with the disarmament* that the United Nations had imposed on the country after the 1991 Gulf War. And because the United States believed that Iraq had illegally developed weapons of mass destruction*. However, no weapons of mass destruction were ever found.

Saddam Hussein was removed from power in 2003. Afterwards, Danish soldiers, together with soldiers from other countries, helped rebuild Iraq after the war and create better living conditions and democracy for the Iraqis.

In 2011, it was decided that Denmark would participate in a military operation in Libya with a mandate from the UN. The operation was to protect the civilian population from abuses by the country's dictator Muammar Al-Gaddafi. Denmark supplied aircraft for the operation and carried out several bombings.

When the terrorist movement Islamic State conquered large parts of Iraq and Syria in 2014, the United States led a military mission to combat the terrorist movement. Denmark also participated with both aircraft and soldiers to train Iraqi soldiers.

However, the removal of Saddam Hussein in Iraq and Muammar Al-Gaddafi in Libya has not been without problems. In both countries, there have subsequently been many conflicts – something akin to civil war – between different groups.

Russia's occupation of the Crimean peninsula in Ukraine in 2014 and the war in Ukraine since 2022 have raised concerns about whether Russia will also attack other countries. NATO has therefore returned to its original focus on being able to defend its own territory* against attacks from other countries.

That is why Denmark, for example, has decided to spend a lot more money on defense up to 2030, so that we, together with the other NATO countries, will be better able to defend ourselves against an attack. In addition, it has been decided in 2024 that more soldiers will be called up and that conscription will be extended from four to 11 months.

In response to the Russian attack on Ukraine, the West has supported Ukraine with weapons and training so that the country can defend itself against the Russian attack. And the West has also tried to weaken the Russian economy by banning the sale of a number of goods to Russia and prohibiting the purchase of Russian oil. Many Western companies have withdrawn from Russia.



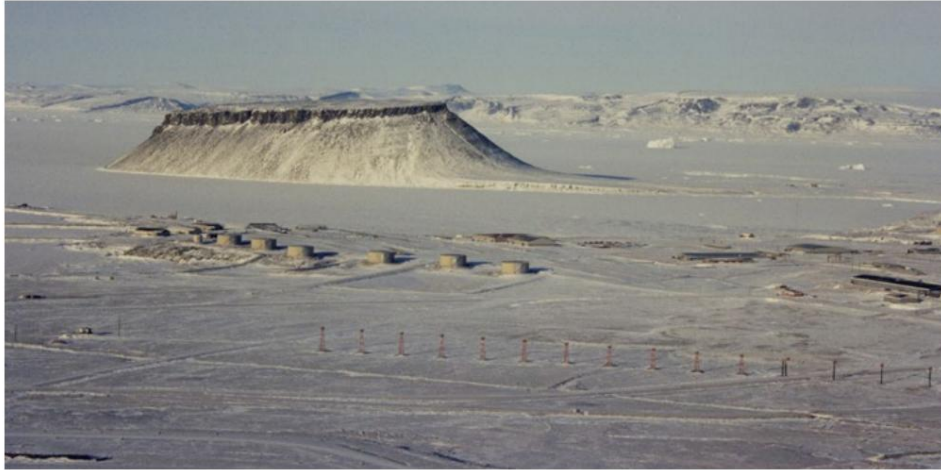
THE NORTHERN KINGDOM, GREENLAND AND THE ARCTIC

Greenland, which is part of the Danish Realm, was of great importance during the Cold War. Greenland is close to both the United States and the then Soviet Union, and you had to fly over Greenland to take the shortest route.

between the USA, Europe and the Soviet Union. The shortest route for missiles in the event of war between the USA and Russia/Soviet Union also goes over Greenland.

Therefore, Greenland had a strategic importance in relation to defense cooperation, and in 1951 Denmark and the United States signed an agreement on the United States' military activities.

in Greenland. That same year, the Americans built a large air base at Qaanaaq (Thule) in northern Greenland. At the base, the United States also built a radar station that could monitor the airspace over Greenland and the sea areas around Greenland that were used for shipping. The base was important for the air defense of the United States and NATO, and it is still used by the United States today, and is called Pituffik Space Base.



The American base at Qaanaaq in northern Greenland (Thule)

The warmer climate and the melting of the ice in and around Greenland provide better opportunities to find oil, gas and minerals that were previously frozen. And if the sea around the Arctic becomes ice-free for large parts of the year in the future, it will open up the possibility of new, shorter shipping routes between the world's continents.



The Danish inspection ship 'Vædderen' patrols the coast of Greenland.

The Arctic region is therefore still in focus for Danish security policy. However, the international powers the USA, Russia and China are all interested in the Arctic.

They are because the countries have an interest in protecting their own country from attacks from others. But also because the countries have economic interests in, for example, mining and the transport of goods by ship. This can challenge the Commonwealth's goal of the Arctic being a peaceful area.

In 2025, it has therefore also been decided to strengthen the Danish defence presence around Greenland, not least to be able to monitor* the area. It has thus been decided to purchase new ships that are particularly suitable for sailing in the Arctic climate and drones that can monitor large areas over long distances.

Fact sheet 25:

Discrimination, anti-Semitism, hate crimes and extremism

Denmark is built on ideals such as freedom and democracy. These are laid down in the Danish Constitution. For example, the Constitution states that you can say or write whatever you want (freedom of expression). The Constitution also states that you can choose the religion you want (freedom of religion). The Constitution also gives you the right to form associations and be a member of associations (freedom of association) and to gather, for example for demonstrations (freedom of assembly).

Individual freedom is therefore a fundamental value in Denmark. But to ensure that freedom is not used to harm others, the state also has the right to restrict freedom. It is said that "freedom must be used responsibly". Therefore, it is illegal - It is easy to abuse freedom, for example to discriminate against others. Discrimination occurs when people are treated differently, or treated worse, because of their religion, political opinion, skin color, gender, ethnicity, sexual orientation, age, etc.

This fact sheet is about:

- Discrimination
 - Anti-Semitism
 - Hate crimes •
- Extremism

There are a number of laws that prohibit discrimination, for example, you may not reject applicants for a job or deny people access to public places because of their race, ethnic origin. You must also not publicly say or write anything that mocks or threatens others because of, for example, their race, skin color, religion or sexual orientation. It is also illegal to publicly support or encourage others to commit a crime – for example by supporting or encouraging violence against a particular group of people. You may also not publicly express your clear support for a terrorist attack.

Although ideals of equality and democracy have a long tradition in Denmark, some still experience discrimination. Studies show that almost half of all people with a non-Western immigrant background in Denmark have experienced discrimination. discriminated against in some way because of their ethnic origin. And studies show that applicants with certain foreign names have a harder time getting a rental - housing or come to a job interview, even if they are just as qualified as applicants with typically Danish names.

The laws that prohibit discrimination are designed to protect religious, ethnic, and sexual minorities from abuse and unfair discrimination. And criminal - Crimes against minorities can be punished particularly harshly if they are committed in because of the victim's ethnic origin, religion, sexual orientation or similar. Such crimes are also called hate crimes.

In the period 2017-22, the police registered 3,107 cases of hate crimes; 1,709 (55 percent) because of the victims' race or ethnicity; 893 (29 percent) because of by the victims' religion and 516 (17 percent) due to the victims' sexual orientation.

The crimes are typically hate speech, violence, vandalism or threats. This corresponds to an average of 517 hate crimes per year during the period or more than one case every day.

But it is difficult to know how many people are actually subjected to hate crimes because many do not report it to the police.

The Jewish minority in Denmark is a group that is particularly vulnerable to hate crimes. In the period 2017-22, the police registered 337 hate crimes against Jews. This is a high number considering that there are a total of 6-8,000 Jews living in Denmark.

Almost every third hate crime reported in Denmark was committed because of the victim's religion, and every tenth of all hate crimes in Denmark were committed against Jews.

For example, in 2019, over 80 tombstones at a Jewish cemetery in Randers were doused with paint and overturned by men from a neo-Nazi movement. This happened symbolically on November 9, the anniversary of Kristallnacht in 1938, when the Nazis, among other things, destroyed and burned Jewish shops, synagogues, homes and schools in Germany.



Outside after the terrorist attack in Photo 1. Tue Schou Pedersen.

In 2015, a terrorist with sympathies for the terrorist organization Islamic State attempted to enter the Jewish synagogue in Copenhagen. He shot and killed a Jewish guard and wounded two police officers outside the synagogue. The terrorist was later killed himself when the police tried to arrest him. Earlier in the day, the terrorist had also attacked the Kulturhuset Krudttønden and shot and killed a film instructor during a debate on freedom of expression.

After the conflict between Israel and Hamas began in October 2023, Jewish citizens in Denmark have experienced more threats and more harassment.

Hate crimes are also committed against other groups. For example, a Danish party leader was convicted in 2020 for stating in a video that "the Danes and Denmark are far too highly developed and advanced to coexist with the very low-level Muslim cultural waste". And in 2017 a man was convicted of having

spat on and punched a gay man in the head on a train.

In 2015, Nazi graffiti with threats was painted and a car was set on fire at an asylum center by a perpetrator who was opposed to Danish refugee policy.

The perpetrator was sentenced to one and a half years in prison.

Other times, crimes are committed because the perpetrators do not like the victim's political views. In 2003, two men attacked then-Prime Minister Anders Fogh Rasmussen and Foreign Minister Per Stig Møller with paint in the Danish Parliament because of Denmark's support for the US invasion of Iraq (the Iraq War).

The two perpetrators were sentenced to three and four months in prison, respectively.

The courts considered it particularly serious that they had attacked representatives of the democratic government. In recent decades, the Police Intelligence Service has had to protect an increasing number of politicians with bodyguards because it assesses that more politicians are threatened with attack or harassment.

Fact sheet 26:

Climate

A large amount of energy consumption – by burning coal, oil and gas (fossil fuels) – in production and transport, among other things, has been crucial for creating the great economic growth of the past 150 years. But it has also led to a large emission of CO₂ and other greenhouse gases into the atmosphere.

We talk about greenhouse gases and the 'greenhouse effect' because these gases – like a greenhouse – trap heat in the atmosphere.

on one side it lets the sun's rays in, but on the other it limits the heat from escaping again. If more greenhouse gases are added to the atmosphere, there will be less heat is released back into the atmosphere. This affects the climate and causes the temperature to rise, causing global warming. Due to global warming, more areas may become desert, more floods and

more extreme heat. This could mean that people will have a harder time living in large parts of the world.

This fact sheet is about:

- Global warming
- The Danish effort for green transition

GLOBAL WARMING – A GLOBAL PROBLEM

It has been more than 100 years since it was discovered that CO₂ emissions could cause global warming. But at the time, it was thought that it would only become a problem in thousands of years. But things have happened much faster, and now we know that CO₂ and other greenhouse gas emissions have already affected our climate.



Forest fire USA In Photo: John

MacColgan.

Since the period 1850-1900, the temperature has risen globally by more than one degree. Historically, this is a large change in just over 100 years. It has been particularly rapid in recent decades, and the trend seems to continue. The UN predicts that the climate will be 1.4 to 4.4 degrees warmer by the end of this century than it was in the period 1850-1900.

The development depends on how much greenhouse gas emissions are reduced globally. In recent decades, Denmark has done a lot to reduce Danes' greenhouse gas emissions. This has meant that Denmark's emissions

from 1990 to 2023 has decreased by approximately 51 percent, partly because energy consumption has become more efficient and because more wind and solar energy is used.

But globally, greenhouse gas emissions have increased significantly during the same period – because the Earth's population is growing rapidly, and more people have money to buy more. requires more production, and then more greenhouse gases are released into the atmosphere.

The problem can therefore only be solved if many other countries also reduce their emissions, and therefore international cooperation is necessary. The countries of the world – not least in the UN – have focused on solving the problem. And many international agreements have been made, including the Paris Agreement in 2015, where almost all the countries of the world have signed on to help reduce global greenhouse gas emissions over the coming decades. In addition, there are agreements within the EU with higher ambitions than the Paris Agreement.

THE DANISH EFFORT

In recent years, climate has been an important issue in Danish politics. In 2014, the Climate Council was established. It is tasked with advising – and assessing – the government's climate policy and making its own recommendations. In its advice, the Climate Council is to focus, among other things, on ensuring that we reduce greenhouse gas emissions in a way that does not cost society too much money and jobs.

In 2019, most political parties agreed on a new climate law. The climate law states that the government must reduce Denmark's greenhouse gas emissions by 70 percent by 2030 compared to 1990. It also states that Denmark must be climate neutral by 2050 at the latest, which means that Denmark must not emit more greenhouse gases than are absorbed. After the Climate Act was passed, the Danish Parliament and the government have made a number of agreements on how to achieve the goals.

The path to achieving these goals must be through a 'green transition'. The green transition is about stopping using 'black' energy sources such as oil and gas, which emit a lot of greenhouse gases, and instead using renewable and green energy sources, such as solar, wind and hydropower. These energy sources are called 'renewable' because they do not run out, and 'green' because they do not emit greenhouse gases, or emit much fewer greenhouse gases than the black energy sources. Renewable energy covered 50 percent of energy consumption in Denmark in 2023 compared to six percent in 1990.

Of the renewable energy sources, wind energy is particularly important in Denmark, which has had wind turbines on land since the 1970s, and in 1991 Denmark got the world's first offshore wind farm, Vindeby, off Lolland. By 2023, wind turbines produced over half of Denmark's electricity consumption.

Denmark is continuing to develop wind energy. As the first country in the world, Denmark has decided to build two energy islands, which will be built in the 2030s. One energy island will be located near Bornholm. The other will be located in the North Sea, approximately 80 km from the west coast of Jutland. It could be the largest and most expensive in Danish history.

construction project. You can't transport electricity from wind turbines over long distances. The islands will therefore collect and convert the energy from the offshore wind turbines so that it can be used for transportation and for the production of electricity. This will provide electricity and heat for many millions of people in different European countries.



Wind Farm near Amager Photo: Tue Bech Schou

Denmark is also working on more efficient heating of homes and, to use green energy for this heating. Increasingly, requirements are being placed on the insulation of buildings in order to save on energy consumption, and public support for homeowners to make their homes more climate-friendly, for example by replacing their oil or gas boilers with heat pumps.

In addition, car taxes have been adjusted according to how much greenhouse gases the cars emit. The goal is to have many more cars driving on electricity (electric cars) rather than cars that run on petrol or diesel.

Transport is one of the areas where Denmark has not yet seriously reduced its greenhouse gas emissions. And a transformation of transport, including many more electric cars, is necessary, according to the Climate Council, to achieve Denmark's climate goals. However, it is already going in the right direction, because many Danes are now buying electric cars instead of new petrol or diesel cars.

Europe has previously purchased a lot of oil and gas from Russia. However, imports have been reduced significantly since Russia's attack on Ukraine in 2022. There has also been more focus on the fact that the green transition is making Europe more independent of Russia, among other things.

The expansion of renewable energy in Europe has increased since 2022, and Denmark, for example, has also, together with several North Sea countries (Netherlands, Belgium, Germany, Great Britain, Norway, etc.) have set major goals that by 2050, many new wind turbines will be built in the North Sea, which can create a lot of energy.

GREEN THREE-PARTY

Part of the greenhouse gas emissions also come from agriculture, which accounts for 60 percent of Denmark's area. This makes Denmark one of the countries in the world where the largest proportion of land is agricultural land. Therefore, the transformation of agriculture is of great importance for Denmark's climate efforts.

Therefore, the government, municipalities and a number of trade unions, environmental organizations and organizations from the business community have entered into a collaboration called "The Green Tripartite". The parties behind the Green Tripartite agreed in 2024 on a large and comprehensive plan to create more nature in Denmark as well as cleaner water in lakes, streams and the sea. And to restructure agriculture so that it pollutes less.

It has been agreed that approximately 15 percent of Denmark's agricultural land, which is larger than Funen and Bornholm combined, must be nature by planting new forests, creating new bogs, swamps, streams and other nature.

With the agreement, Denmark is also the first country in the world to introduce a direct tax on agricultural CO2 emissions – the so-called "CO2 tax" – so that farmers must pay for CO2 emissions from their cows, pigs, sheep, chickens and other animals.



Cows in a field in Denmark.

Photo: Malene Thyssen.

Glossary

GLOSSARY

- access – opportunity to enter. Access to higher education means that you have the opportunity to enter, for example, a vocational college or a university, for example because you have an exam that gives you access.
- tax – money you pay to the government when you buy or sell something.
- decision – the fact that one has decided how something should be.
- crucial – which means a lot; is very important.
- decide – determine. For example, the courts decide what punishment a criminal person should receive.
- dependent, to be – unable to live without; to need.
- depending on – it depends.
- interrogate – ask questions about what you have done.
- abolish – stop having.
- resignation letter – document where, for example, a minister asks for permission to quit with being a minister.
- reflect – match; be the same as.
- Marketing – a subject at HHX that deals with business and marketing.
- share – share of ownership in a company. When you buy a share, you become a co-owner of the company. In large companies there are many – often more millions – of shares. Therefore, you only own very little of a company for each share you own.
- acknowledge – accept.
- appeal – complain about.
- view/political view – political stance, ideology, opinions about society.
- employment certificate – document that shows that you are employed at a specific place workplace.
- labor – people who do a job
- advanced – highly developed
- (ethnic) background – culture, race or nationality. • (on that) background – therefore; because of that.
- need for – need for.
- authorization – right to.
- drunk – drunk, having drunk too much alcohol.
- occupation – the act of a country entering another country with soldiers and taking over it and then ruling over the country it has taken (occupied). In 1940, Germany occupied Denmark.
- condition – the fact that something only applies if something else is in order. Example: She cooks if he does the shopping. The fact that he does the shopping is the condition for her to cook.
- contribute – help with something common, for example with work or money.
- assistance – help.
- be exposed to – experience.
- industry – profession that belongs to a specific area of work, e.g. construction industry (e.g. bricklayer, carpenter, joiner).
- break up with – stop working with; say that you no longer work with will be part of something.
- bow down – accept something without protesting.

- the national identity of the Danes – the Danes' shared thoughts about what is important about Denmark and what it means to be Danish. For example, the Danish language, the royal family, democracy, the welfare state or Denmark's nature.
- part-time – when, for example, you work or study for fewer hours per day, week, month or year than those who work full-time.
- run hospitals – make sure the hospitals function.
- greenhouse gases – gases that contribute to the greenhouse effect, such as carbon dioxide (CO₂), methane (CH₄) and ozone (O₃).
- discussion – discussion.
- animal welfare – ensuring that animals are healthy and well-being.
- baptism certificate – a small child receives a baptism certificate when they have been baptized in, for example, the Danish church. The baptism certificate contains their name and date of birth, etc.
- covered – paid.
- covered in fields – with grain and other plants all over it.
- covered by – which applies.
- cover – apply.
- John the Baptist – John (who is called Hans in Danish) was a cousin of Jesus and born six months before him, on June 24. John was the first to baptize* people. That is why he was called John the Baptist. He also baptized Jesus.
- baptize – the priest in a Christian church pours some water on a person's head if the person wants to be a member of a Christian faith. If it is a small child, the child is also given a name.
- baptism – the act of the priest in a Christian church pouring a little water on a person's head if the person wishes to become a member of a Christian faith. If it is a small child, the child is also given a name during baptism.
- investigate – investigate.
- descendant – person who, for example, belongs to a particular family or a particular nationality.
- suitable – which can be used.
- Eid – a Muslim holiday.
- explosives – e.g. substances that can explode and cause damage, destruction and kill, e.g. dynamite.
- export, export – sell abroad.
- single subject – the fact that you take the hf by taking one subject or a few subjects at a time.
You can do this, for example, if you have left school after 9th grade and have a job, but want to get a high school diploma because, for example, you want to enter higher education.
- declare yourself fit to serve military service – be told that you can be used as a soldier.
- euphoric substances – narcotics, e.g. hashish, cocaine, heroin, etc.
- fall on – about dates and days of the week or months: Examples: This year falls (= is it) Christmas Eve on a Wednesday; this year Easter falls in April.
- Family Court – an organization under the state that handles cases concerning families. These may include cases concerning adoption, divorce and custody.
- waters – an area of water, for example in an ocean, where ships can sail.
- Lent – a period when you fast, i.e. you don't eat at all or don't eat what you usually eat, or when it is forbidden to eat certain things, such as meat.
- determined – determined.

- remove – take away.
- UN – United Nations (UN – United Nations) a world organization that was formed after World War II in 1945 by 51 countries, including Denmark. The UN currently (2021) has 193 member states.
- democracy – democracy. •
- improvements – to make something better.
- prohibit – to make forbidden.
- prevent – to try to prevent something. •
- association/in association – together, in community.
- constitution – fundamental (basic) rules for how a state should be governed and are organized. Normally, these rules are written down in a constitution.
- promote – for example, give a better job with a higher salary.
- negotiator – makes agreements with.
- prevent – so that something does not happen.
- demand – say that one must; demand.
- wealth – a lot of money.
- assembly, democratic – parliament.
- familiar with – which one knows well.
- parental authority – the fact that you as a parent have the right to decide over a child until the child reaches the age of majority, the day they turn 18.
- promote – make better. •
- propose legislation – make proposals for new laws; propose new laws.
- deprived of liberty – being in prison or in detention.
- fertility – the ability of people to have children, or the ability of the earth to produce, for example, grain, plants or trees.
- fundamental – basic; fundamental.
- firing – being told by your boss that you have lost your job.
- carry out – implement; realize; make real.
- fee – money that you pay to, for example, a public authority that, for example, makes a document to one.
- ghetto – residential area where foreigners from non-Western countries make up over half of the population and with many problems, such as unemployment, crime or low income and low education. • giant – something that is very large.
- global warming – change in the Earth's climate due to the increase in average temperature.
- approval – document stating that something meets necessary (often legal) requirements, i.e. meets certain rules.
- intervene – to interfere, prevent.
- primary school – in primary school, the basic (basic) subjects are taught, e.g. reading, writing and arithmetic.
- Church service – when people gather in church – typically on a Sunday – to honor God. Hymns are sung and the priest speaks about the Bible and Christianity.
- hate crimes – crimes, such as violence, vandalism or threats, motivated by hatred of people because of their religion, political opinion, skin color, gender, ethnicity, sexual orientation, age, etc.
- act – to do something.
- pagan – no religion other than Christianity, Islam or Judaism.

- The Holy Spirit – in Christianity, God is believed to consist of three parts: the Father (God), the Son (Jesus Christ) and the Holy Spirit. These three are also called the Trinity (= three in one).
- secret/free and secret elections – everyone can stand for election, and no one can see who or which party you vote for.
- smallholder – farmer who owns very little or no land.
- holiday – a time of one or more days when, for example, a religious celebration is held.
- mock – to make fun of and belittle someone with disrespectful, hateful words.
- import, import – buy abroad.
- influence – help make decisions.
- be part of – be a part of.
- summoned – to be told that you have to attend something specific.
- income – money you earn.
- libel – saying something negative and false about others.
- initiate – start; set in motion.
- Christmas tree – a fir tree that you bring into the living room and decorate.
- chapel – side room in a church that is used for special things.
- capitulation – the act of stopping fighting during, for example, a war, when you feel that you are losing.
- barracks – where soldiers in an army live and weapons are stored.
- tie together – tie together.
- collective – which applies to everyone.
- confirmation – when baptized children of about 14 years old come to church and say yes that they are members of the Evangelical Lutheran religious community (= the Danish People's Church).
- consequence – result.
- dues – money you pay to be a member of, for example, an association.
- crucify – execute a person by hanging them on a cross.
- requirements – what is necessary to do.
- spoils of war – things that warriors have taken from those they are at war with, or that they has robbed people.
- violate – disrespect.
- demand – says that you must have something (changed).
- stratum – group of people who have roughly the same social level (e.g. roughly the same type of education, same type of work, same economy).
- companion – another person who is with you and can help.
- equality – that people have equal rights and opportunities, regardless of whether they are men, women, homosexuals, etc.
- equality – the fact that everyone is of equal value.
- market economy – when goods and services are produced, bought and sold freely by private companies.
- Weapons of mass destruction – weapons that can affect entire populations, i.e. chemical, biological, radioactive and nuclear weapons.
- pharmaceutical company – a company that develops and sells medicine.
- congregation – organized community where everyone has the same kind of religion.
It can also be a smaller part of the organized community.
- mentor – supervisor.

- midsummer song – a specific song about midsummer (June 23rd = mid-summer).
- suspicion – the belief that someone has done something forbidden.
- the authorities – the public sector (state and municipality).
- blackout curtains – black or very dark curtains that cover the windows so that no light can get through. Blackout curtains were used during World War II during air raids. This way you couldn't see from the planes.
see where there were houses and cities.
- defeat – to lose, e.g. a war.
- disarmament – when a country reduces the size of its military
- closed – closed. veto – say no.
- policy of neutrality – when a country does not participate or choose sides in other countries' wars and conflicts.
- niche – a limited part of a market, a special area within commerce with goods.
- note – write.
- refuse – say no.
- close friend – good friend.
- public places – where everyone is allowed to be.
- extent/a certain extent – to a certain extent.
- extent/to a great extent – to a great extent. •
extensive – large.
- support – support. • give
up – tell. You have to tell the tax authorities how much money you have.
earned.
- inform – tell.
- maintain – ensure that something continues.
- create – start.
- originally – in the beginning.
- armament – when a country improves its military, for example by acquiring more soldiers and better weapons
- notice of termination – the fact that you must receive written notice that you no longer have a job at a workplace, that you have been fired/dismissed. You must receive notice some time before you are fired, for example three months in advance.
- nominate a candidate – choose a person who will try to be elected to the People's
the Thing in a general election.
- stand for election – register to, for example, try to be elected to the Folketinget in a general election
parliamentary elections.
- rise from the dead – become alive again.
- supervise/keep under supervision – take care of; keep an eye on.
- admit someone – take someone into a school or an education.
- dyslexic – who has problems reading and writing, including due to congenital
problems going from letter to sound in a systematic way.
- conviction – the fact that one firmly believes in something.
- collective agreement – written agreement between two parties / collective agreement –
agreement that applies to everyone.
- overall political guidelines – general political principles.
- profit – the fact that you have earned more money than you have spent on your business
kindness.

- monitor – keep an eye on.
- planned economy – when the state plans and decides which goods and services which is produced.
- professional bachelor's degree – a medium-term education (usually 2-4 years) that allows you to get a specific job, for example as a teacher or as a nurse.
- vocational college – an educational institution where you can take a medium-term education as, for example, a teacher or nurse.
- to impress – to influence.
- marked by – characterized by.
- relatives – family members.
- influence – do something that means that something happens to someone else or something else. For example, people affect nature by driving a car. This may mean that nature, for example, becomes polluted. And this may in turn mean that people become ill.
- the racism clause – part of the law that states that you are not allowed to speak publicly nasty about people because of their race.
- framework – rules for how, for example, society or an institution should be, i.e. For example, what you can and cannot do.
- explain – explain.
- regulate – control by means of laws and regulations.
- relationships – contact with other people, such as family, friends and colleagues.
- relevant – which is important for what you want. For example, if you want to be a doctor, the relevant education is to study medicine at university.
- resource – a supply of things or materials that are important for, for example, the economy.
- legal – which has to do with laws and regulations.
- The Danish Commonwealth or The Danish Commonwealth – Denmark, the Faroe Islands and Greenland. The Danish Commonwealth is part of the Kingdom of Denmark, where all three regions are part of a constitutional monarchy. There is something that the three parts have in common. For example, the three parts share the Queen. There are also many things that the three parts do not have in common. For example, each of the three parts has its own flag.
- make available, provide – give the right to use; bestow.
- Redstockings movement – a socialist movement in the 70s that fought for women's rights.
- objective reason – a good reason that is about something that others can also see and understand.
- association – union.
- school board – every 4 years, the parents of the children at a school elect five to seven parents to be on the school board, which also includes some teachers and some children from the school. The school board decides, for example, how the teaching should be organised, how many hours the children should have at the different grades (0-9/10th grade) and how many parent meetings and excursions there must be.
- explosives – any material that can explode, such as dynamite.
- extend a safety net – ensure that everyone who needs it, for example, has a place to stay and food to eat.
- stand as a candidate – register to try to be elected as a shop steward, for example.
- punishable – actions that can be punished, for example with a fine or imprisonment.

- stream – watch or listen to content, such as movies, series, music or podcasts, directly over the internet, without downloading it to your mobile phone, tablet or computer.
- contrary to/in violation of – something that one is not allowed to say or do, for example according to a law.
- strengthen – make better; make stronger. Strengthen the dialogue between school and home: Ensure that teachers and parents communicate well/better with each other.
- special position – being something special. talk/be about – be about. available – easy to find; get hold of.
- territory – land area.
- restraining order – a person is prohibited from seeking out, contacting or following another person person.
- attached – who has a lot or a little work in a particular place. A midwife is attached to the health center: one or more times a week there is a midwife at the health center.
- attach importance – believe that something is important.
- subsidies – money you get from the government to help pay for expenses. A subsidy is usually only part of what something costs.
- connection – support.
- expedition – travel to one or more places, for example to rob or wage war.
- interpret – explain what something means.
- well-being – the fact that one feels good; that one thrives.
- religious community – organized community where everyone has the same kind of religion.
- threat – something that could become dangerous.
- draw a boundary – make a boundary.
- force – to say that someone must do something; to say that something is a duty.
- typical – normal.
- independently of – without thinking about.
- expenses – money you spend.
- constitute – be.
- appoint – officially give someone a task.
- subjected to a crime – someone does something to you that is illegal.
- print tax – notify how much people must pay in taxes.
- informal – in a relaxed and everyday way.
- incapacitated – who has lost the rights that adults, persons of full age over the age of 18, have. This can happen, for example, if a person is very seriously mentally ill.
- deficit – the fact that you have earned less money than you have spent on your company.
- support – help, for example with money.
- oppress – make it difficult for people to live as they want.
- Ministry of Education – the ministry that deals with the teaching and education of children, young people and some groups of adults.
- exception – something to which a rule or law does not apply.
- youth cohort – a cohort is a group of people born in the same year, e.g. all people born in 1987. A youth cohort is a group of young people who have left school in the same year, e.g. 2014.
- lasting – never ending.
- notice – normally you are not fired from one day to the next. You are given notice (notice) about it a while before, e.g. a few months.
- maintain – ensuring that, for example, houses are repaired when they need it.

- concerning – which concerns.
- concern – concern, be about.
- adopt – decide that something should apply.
- well-run – which functions well, which has good management.
- welfare benefits – money, things or help that you receive as a citizen of a welfare society so that you can have a good life. These can include free schooling, medical care and a pension.

- welfare – feeling good because you know that you will not lack help (e.g. money or things) if you need it. This means that as a citizen of a welfare society you can, for example, receive free education, medical care and a pension.
- prosperity – wealth, how much money you have.
- left-wing – e.g. socialist, social democrat or communist.
- witness/be a witness to – see something happen. •
- conditions/same conditions – same conditions*. • violent
– using physical violence, e.g. hitting.
- arms race – when two or more countries compete to have the most and best arms.
- emphasis/emphasize – to believe that something is important.
- conscription – obligation to be a soldier.
- benefit – money, things or services that are received or given, for example as help.
- utterance – what is said.
- increase – make larger.
- economic growth – when a country becomes richer.
- freedom of thought – freedom to think and believe what one wants, i.e. the right to decide for oneself decide what you want to believe and what you want to think.
- cohort – is a group of people born in the same year, e.g. all people born in 1987. A youth cohort is a group of young people who have left school in the same year, e.g. 2014.

